

Connecting the dots of technology and ethics

Society, Technology, and Ethics

Lecture

Visiting Voice

Group Time

Scan to interact in real-time

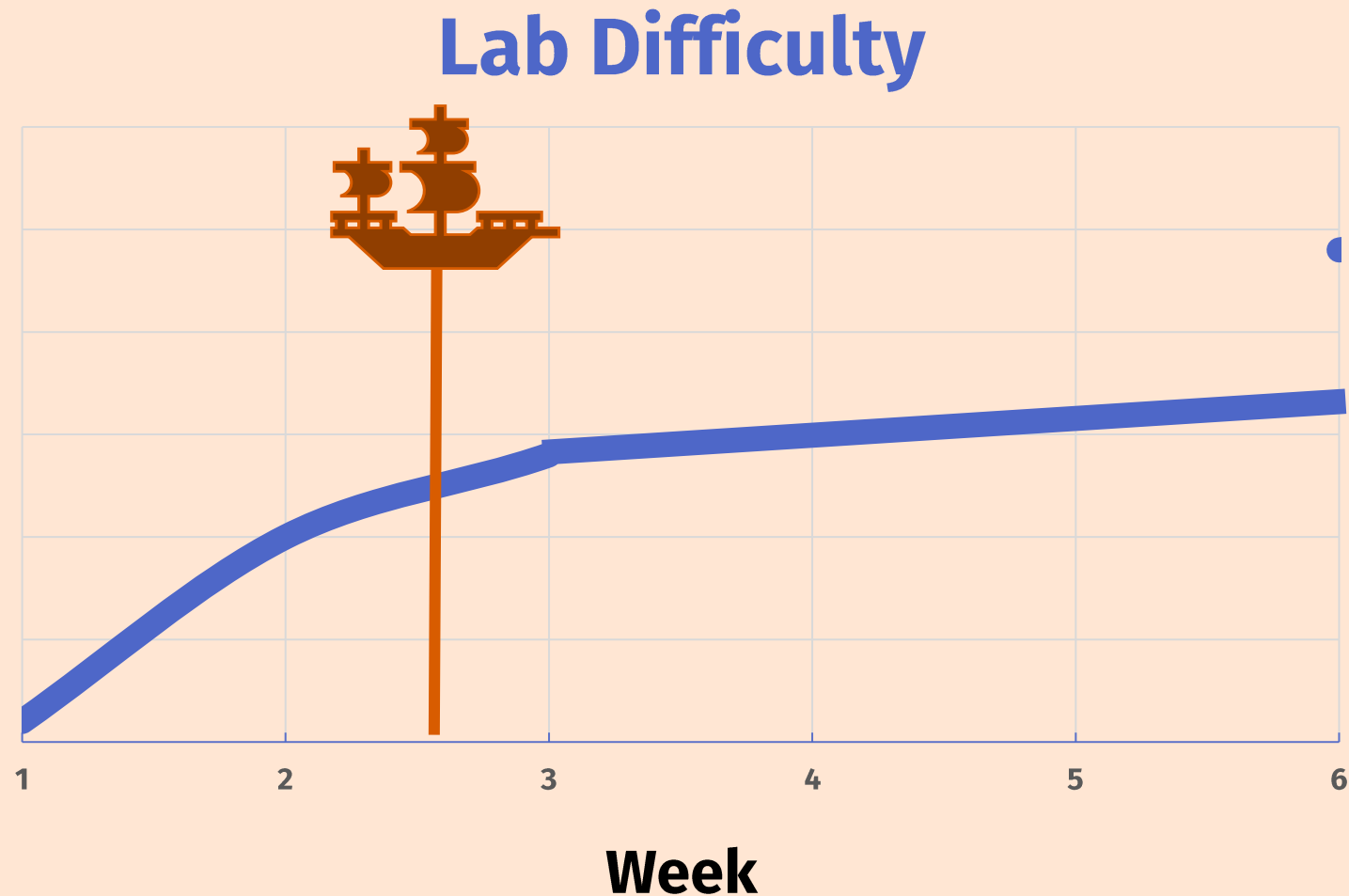


Or go to <http://poll.albertmaps.com/> and use the code:

#191A26

Albert Kochaphum
Lecture 3 | July 6th, 2026

Lab difficulty will start to plateau



Theme of the week

The societal impacts of technology

Connecting the dots of technology and ethics

Lecture



Lecture

Visiting Voice

Group Time

Lecture

Alwards

Lecture

Alwards

Lecture

Pokémon Always
Version:

Amazing X-tra Credit Labs

and
why

They are awesome!



Nice Meowstic-king the map title in the center!

Sophia Nguyen

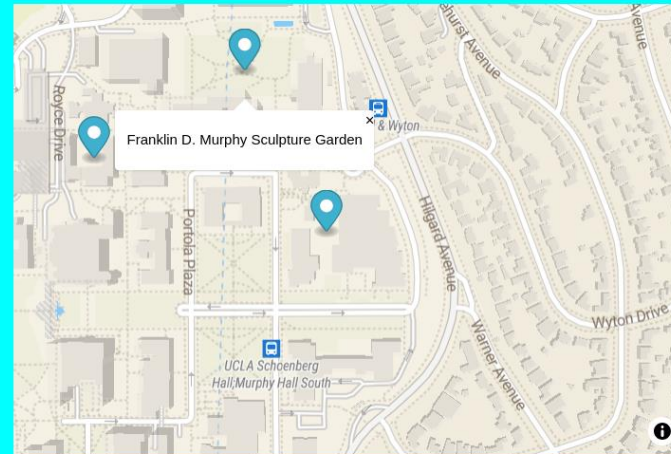


Hello World!!!

Sophia's Awesome Map and Etc.



My Favorite Outdoor Study Spots at UCLA!



<https://snguyen1237.github.io/191a-labs/week1/index.html>

Bunnleby-utiful layout and Links

Evan Sang

Lab 1

About Me!

My name is Evan, and I'm a fourth-year from UCLA with a Statistics and Data Science major and a Digital Humanities minor. I love the practice of narrative building through data visualization and map-making as a counter-practice to the way we see data used in service of empire.

Here's a photo of me (totally)



I believe that data doesn't only have to be used as a tool for colonialism. My hope is to use critical cartography and data visualization within community organizing to better propagate organizational vision, strategy, and campaigns.

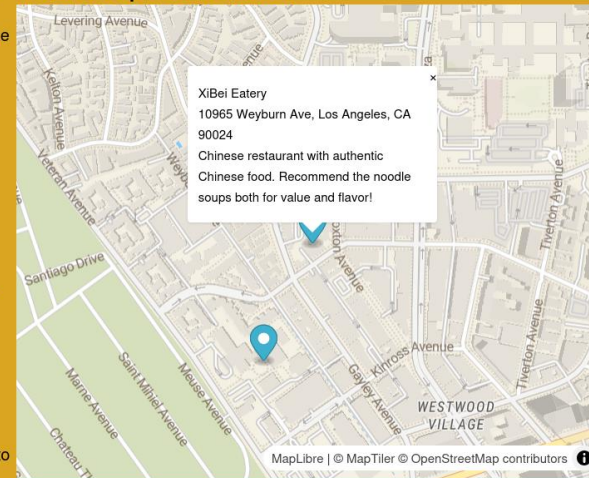
Here are some of my favorite maps:

- [Interactive Encyclopedia of the Palestinian Question--Places](#)
- [UCLA Cops off Campus Abolition Map](#)

Besides being a nerd, I also love to eat out! Here's a list of my favorite places to eat in Westwood (also listed on the map):

1. House of Mandi
 2. XiBei Eatery
 3. The Spot Street Pupusas
- Copyright(2026)

Best Food Spots in Westwood



<https://e-sang.github.io/26s-asianam-191a-labs/week-1/index.html>

Legendary Xerneas tounding design of the week!

Madison Yang



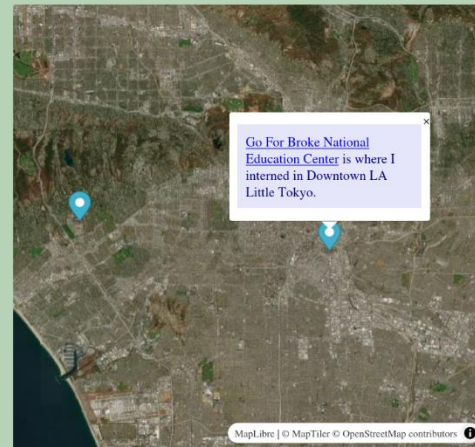
Homepage for Asia Am 191A Maps

Places I've volunteered at

About me



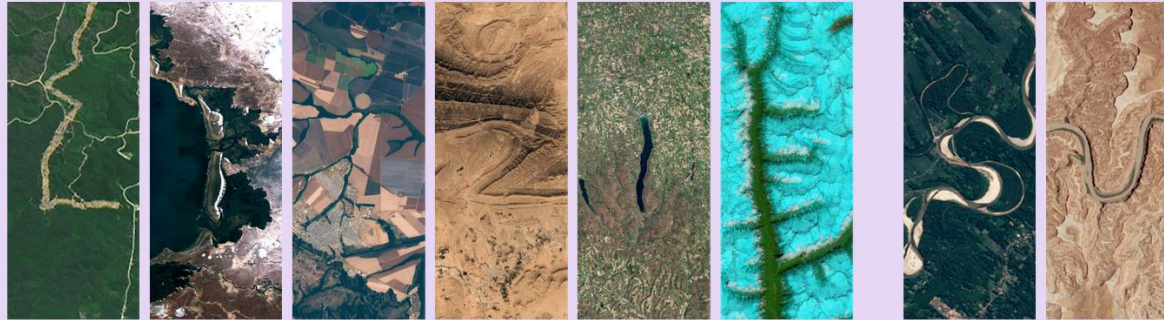
Hi! Welcome to my homepage for Asia Am 191A. My name is Madison and I'm heading into my fourth year at UCLA. I'm a San Diego native and 2.5 generation Korean American. I love In-n-out as much as a good Korean bbq. My goals as a critical digital map maker are to:



<https://snguyen1237.github.io/191a-labs/week1/index.html>

The second Yveltal-ward of the week

Lizzie Su



Images courtesy of NASA Landsat

Welcome to Lizzie's Portfolio!



Hi, I'm Lizzie Su! I'm a rising 4th year studying Geophysics with a minor in Geospatial Information Systems & Technology at UCLA.

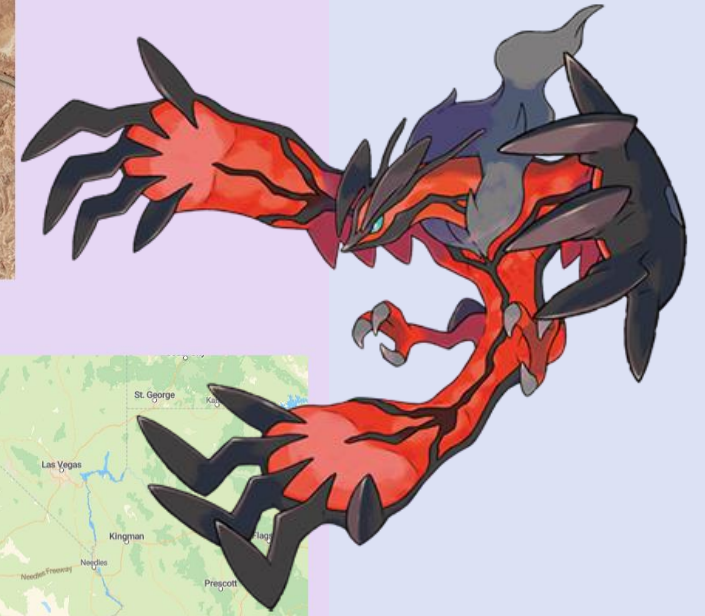
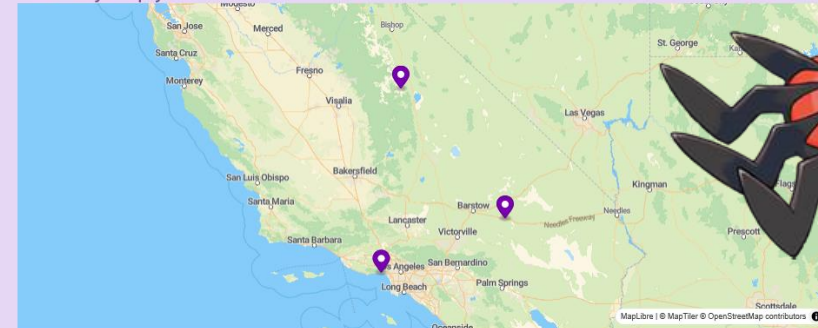
My goal as a critical cartographer is to generate awareness of systemic violence and build interest in radical movements by forcing viewers to question their assumptions about where they live and work. Land has never been just an economic resource or simply a background for display. What does it really mean to ask where?

Outside of school, I enjoy:

- Cooking and baking
- Playing tennis
- Listening to music
- Practicing instruments like violin and erhu

Connect via [LinkedIn](#). Copyright Elizabeth Su (2026)

Some of my Geophysical Field Sites



<https://lzzes.github.io/ss26-asia-am-191a-labs/week1/index.html>

Connecting the dots of technology and ethics

Society, Technology, and Ethics

Lecture

Alwards

Lecture

Theme of the week

The societal impacts of technology

**What is the relationship between
society and technology?**

Inside a European push to outlaw creepy ads

Natasha Lomas @riptari / 9:30 AM PDT • October 21, 2021



Comment

<https://techcrunch.com/2021/10/21/inside-a-european-push-to-outlaw-creepy-ads/>

Featured Article

How Europe has expanded its bid to disrupt Big Tech

Digital Market Act gets new interoperability requirements, more choice screens, wider FRAND and limits on data for ad tracking...

Natasha Lomas @riptari / 12:02 PM PDT • March 25, 2022



Comment



<https://techcrunch.com/2022/03/25/how-europe-has-expanded-its-bid-to-disrupt-big-tech/>

Report reveals Big Tech's last minute lobbying to weaken EU rules

Natasha Lomas @riptari / 3:01 PM PDT • April 22, 2022



Comment

Big Tech boosts EU lobbying

New EU Transparency Register update show that Big Tech firms boosted their EU lobbying in 2021. Their combined lobby spending exceeded 27 million euros.

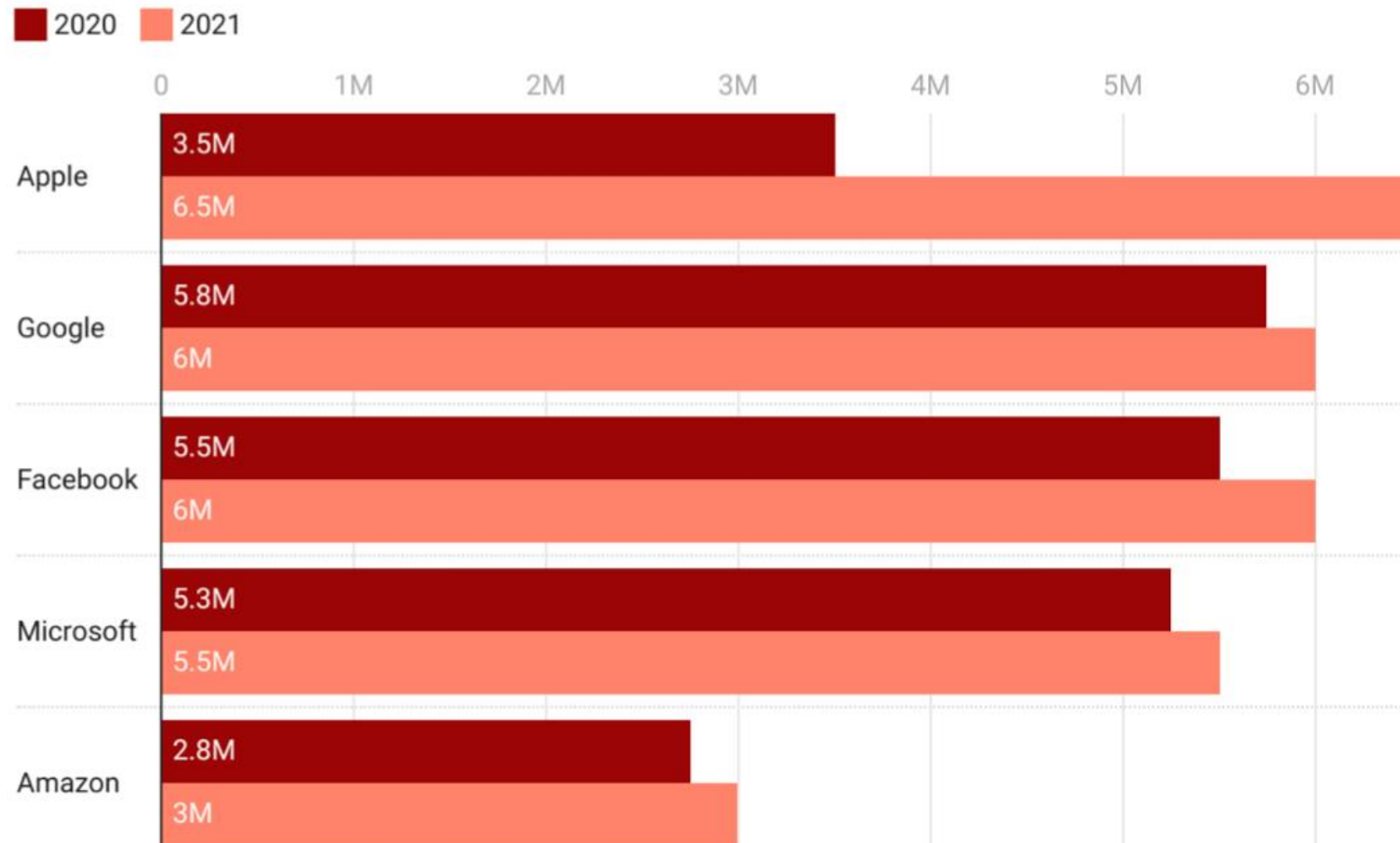


Chart: Corporate Europe Observatory • Source: EU Transparency Register • Created with Datawrapper

04.21.2022

UNITED STATES

WAR AND IMPERIALISM / RICH PEOPLE



Lockheed Martin and Friends Don't Want You to Know What They're Up To

BY

DANAKA KATOVICH

The boards of defense companies like Lockheed Martin and Boeing are encouraging their shareholders to vote against transparency measures. Maybe the US government shouldn't fund companies whose profits would be harmed by the collection of human rights data?



A US soldier fires an FGM-148 Javelin missile during a combined arms live fire exercise in Jordan on August 27, 2019. (Sgt. Liane Hatch / US Army via Wikimedia Commons)

<https://www.jacobinmag.com/2022/04/defense-contractors-human-rights-transparency-lockheed-raytheon>

Are we **barking** up the wrong tree?

N.Y.P.D. Robot Dog's Run Is Cut Short After Fierce Backlash

The Police Department will return the device earlier than planned after critics seized on it as a dystopian example of overly aggressive policing.

 Give this article  



The Police Department used a robotic dog like this one from Boston Dynamics. The machine, which the police named Digidog, became a source of heated debate. Josh Reynolds/Associated Press



By **Mihir Zaveri**

Published April 28, 2021 Updated May 11, 2021

Is there anything negative when institutions use technology to reinforce society?

NYPD doesn't think so.



This comes 2 years later after the initial outcry.

<https://abc7.com/nypd-police-dog-robot-new-york-city/13114623/>

A sign of the Dystopian times?

New York City Brings Back Dystopian Robot Police Dogs

'Digidog is out of the pound,' New York City Mayor Eric Adams declared, not ominously.

C.J. CIARAMELLA | 4.12.2023 3:12 PM



<https://reason.com/2023/04/12/new-york-city-brings-back-dystopian-robot-police-dogs/>

Doggone it, even here in Los Angeles!

 **DAILY BREEZE**   

NEWS • News

LA City Council delays vote on accepting 'robot dog' donation

Councilwoman Traci Park said she would never support something that "violates our constitutional rights" or puts the city on a path to a "dystopian" or "Orwellian" future."

By **CITY NEWS SERVICE** | news@socalnews.com |
PUBLISHED: March 7, 2023 at 3:27 p.m. | UPDATED: March 8, 2023 at 12:56 p.m.

<https://www.dailybreeze.com/2023/03/07/la-city-council-delays-vote-on-accepting-robot-dog-donation/>

Civil Society pushes back.. For now.



<https://www.latimes.com/california/story/2023-03-07/la-city-council-tables-police-robot-dog-vote-2-months>

What about altering research to suit an agenda?

FLORIDA

Florida surgeon general altered key findings in study on Covid-19 vaccine safety

Joseph Ladapo defended the move, saying revisions are a normal part of assessing such analysis.



Joseph Ladapo, a well-known Covid-19 vaccine skeptic, faced a backlash from the medical community after he made the assertions. | Joe Raedle/Getty Images

By AREK SARKISSIAN
04/24/2023 01:59 PM EDT



<https://www.politico.com/news/2023/04/24/florida-surgeon-general-covid-vaccine-00093510>

What about limiting searches to suit an agenda?



What about limiting what can be said?



Technology conflating anti-Zionism (a settler-colonial project) with anti-Semitism

Community + Technology + Ethics = Necessary

Can AI and Data really save the day?



Context: Data (middle) is an android.

Can AI and Data really save the day?

ThePrint

Home › Features › AI future is good for environment. It will change power consumption, speed...

Features

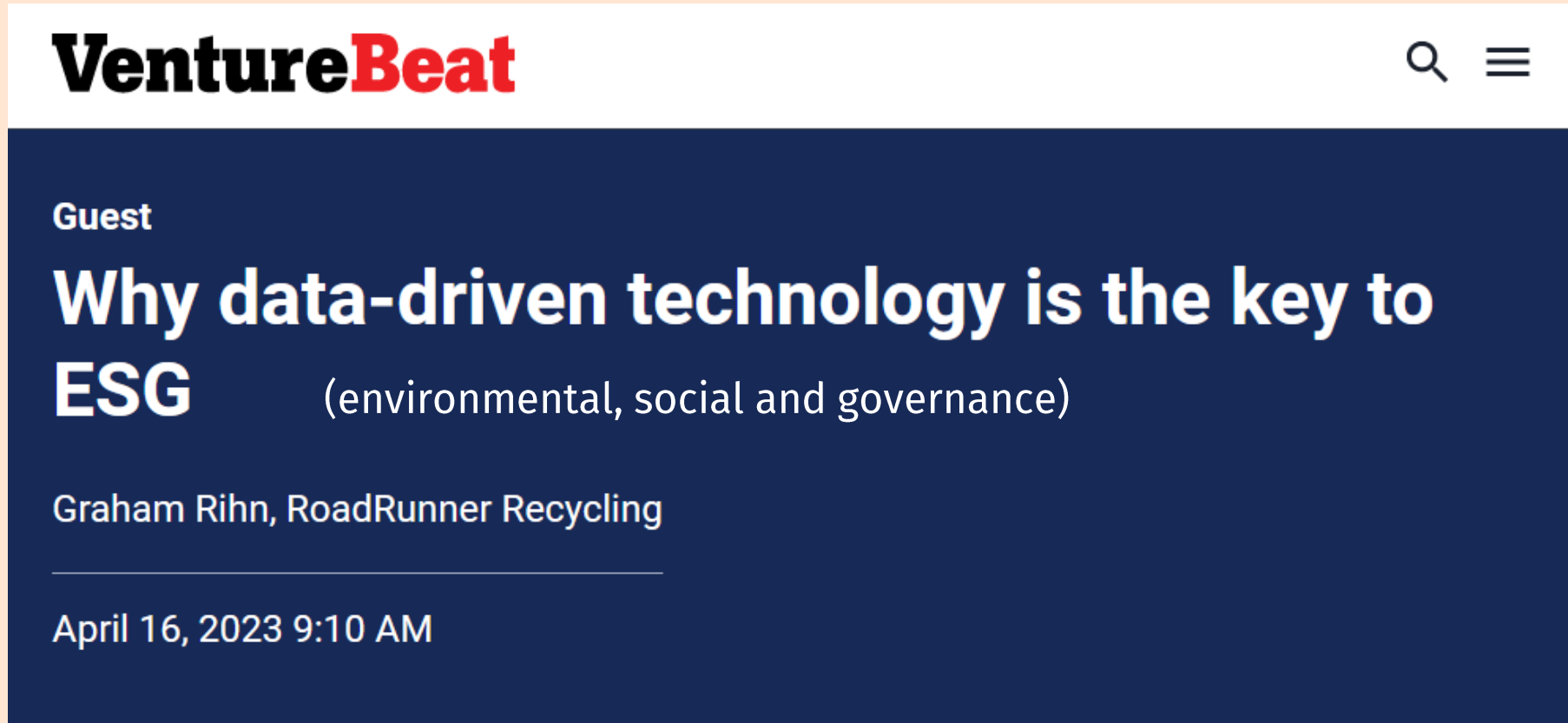
AI future is good for environment. It will change power consumption, speed up innovation

Human behaviour and technology are focal points of interest for most industries around the world. The fifth industrial revolution is all about that.

NIDHIMA TANEJA 24 April, 2023 11:20 am IST

<https://theprint.in/features/ai-future-is-good-for-environment-it-will-change-power-consumption-speed-up-innovation/1536008/>

Can AI and Data really save the day?

A screenshot of a VentureBeat article header. The top navigation bar is white with the 'VentureBeat' logo in black and red, a search icon, and a menu icon. The main content area has a dark blue background. The word 'Guest' is in white. The title 'Why data-driven technology is the key to ESG' is in large white font, with '(environmental, social and governance)' in smaller white font below it. The author 'Graham Rihn, RoadRunner Recycling' is in white below a thin white line. The date 'April 16, 2023 9:10 AM' is in white at the bottom.

VentureBeat  

Guest

Why data-driven technology is the key to ESG

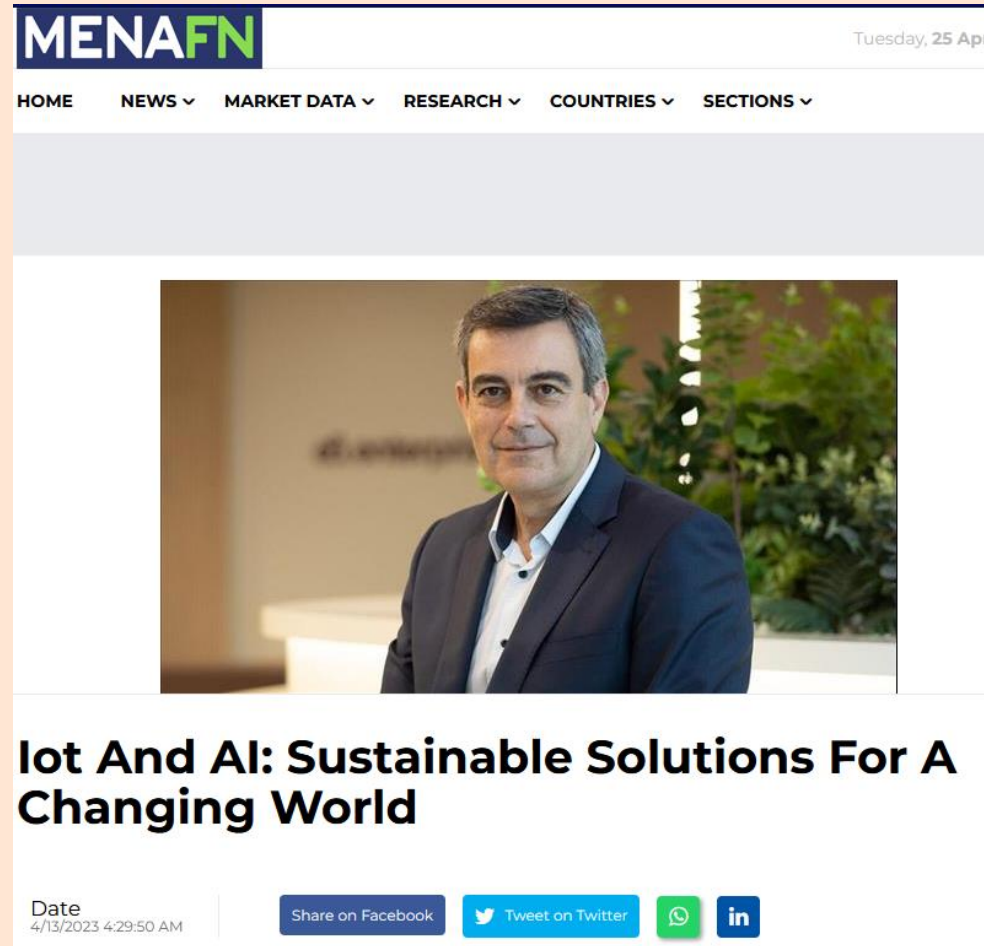
(environmental, social and governance)

Graham Rihn, RoadRunner Recycling

April 16, 2023 9:10 AM

<https://theprint.in/features/ai-future-is-good-for-environment-it-will-change-power-consumption-speed-up-innovation/1536008/>

Can AI and Data really save the day?



<https://menafn.com/1106000730/Iot-And-AI-Sustainable-Solutions-For-A-Changing-World>

Who is tech actually saving/serving?

02.17.2021

GERMANY

CAPITAL / SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

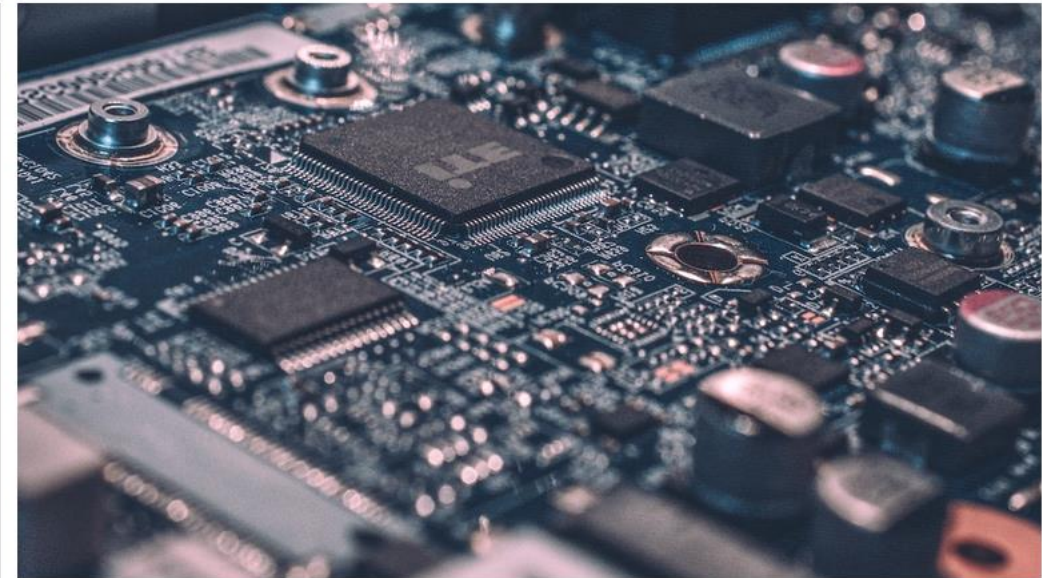


Under Capitalism, “Labor-Saving” Technology Only Adds to Our Workload

BY

PETER SCHADT / HANS ZOBEL

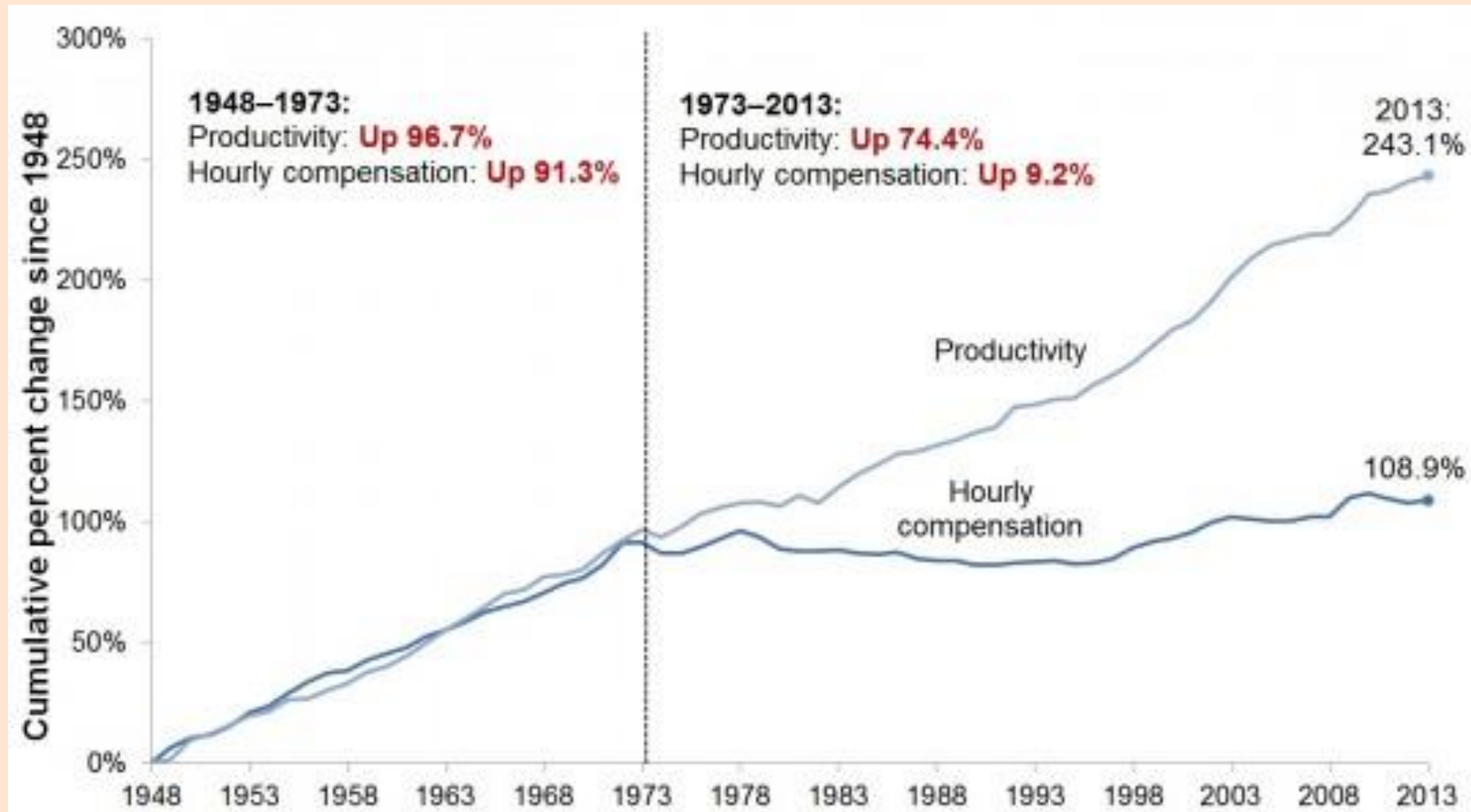
Upon its launch ten years ago, Germany's Industry 4.0 program promised a fourth industrial revolution changing the way we work. Yet for all the talk of novelty, it followed age-old capitalist imperatives: using labor-saving technology not to lessen our workload but subject us to even tighter workplace discipline.



In many parts of the world, working conditions are deteriorating and digitalization is being blamed for this. (Unsplash)

<https://www.jacobinmag.com/2022/04/defense-contractors-human-rights-transparency-lockheed-raytheon>

Who is tech actually saving/serving?



<https://aflcio.org/2015/1/15/five-causes-wage-stagnation-united-states>

Disturbing?

Quick

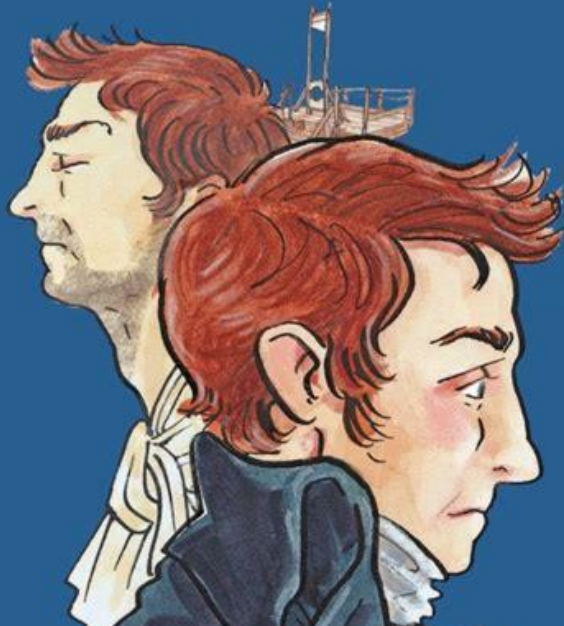
TALE OF TWO Tech Companies and current events

CHARLES DICKENS



Basecamp

<https://github.com/basecamp>



Twitter

<https://github.com/twitter>

Examples to look at how technology and society are connected...



JASON FRIED

April 26, 2021

Changes at Basecamp

At Basecamp, we treat our **company as a product**. It's not a rigid thing that exists, it's a flexible, malleable idea that evolves. We aren't stuck with what we have, we can create what we want. Just as we improve products through iteration, we iterate on our company too.

Recently, we've made some internal company changes, which, taken in total, collectively feel like a full version change. It deserves an announcement.

<https://world.hey.com/jason/changes-at-basecamp-7f32afc5>

1. No more societal and political discussions on our company Basecamp account. Today's social and political waters are especially choppy. Sensitivities are at 11, and every discussion remotely related to politics, advocacy, or society at large quickly spins away from pleasant. You shouldn't have to wonder if staying out of it means you're complicit, or wading into it means you're a target. These are difficult enough waters to navigate in life, but significantly more so at work. It's become too much. **It's a major distraction.** It saps our energy, and redirects our dialog towards dark places. It's not healthy, it hasn't served us well. And we're done with it on our company Basecamp account where the work happens. People can take the conversations with willing co-workers to Signal, Whatsapp, or even a personal Basecamp account, but it can't happen where the work happens anymore. *Update: [David has shared some more details](#) and more of the internal announcement on his HEY World blog.*

6. No forgetting what we do here. We make project management, team communication, and email software. **We are not a social impact company.** Our impact is contained to what we do and how we do it. We write business books, blog a ton, speak regularly, we open source software, we give back an inordinate amount to our industry given our size. And we're damn proud of it. Our work, plus that kind of giving, should occupy our full attention. **We don't have to solve deep social problems,** chime in publicly whenever the world requests our opinion on the major issues of the day, or get behind one movement or another with time or treasure. These are all important topics, but they're not our topics at work — they're not what we collectively do here. Employees are free to take up whatever cause they want, support whatever movements they'd like, and speak out on whatever horrible injustices are being perpetrated on this group or that (and, unfortunately, there are far too many to choose from). But that's their business, not ours. We're in the business of making software, and a few tangential things that touch that edge. **We're responsible for ourselves.** That's more than enough for us.

April 26, 2021

Changes at Basecamp

At Basecamp, we treat our company as a product. It's not a rigid thing that exists, it's a flexible, malleable idea that evolves. We aren't stuck with what we have, we can create what we want. Just as we improve products through iteration, we iterate on our company too. Recently, we've made some internal company changes, which, taken i...

[Read more](#)

April 24, 2021

I bought a sauna

I bought a sauna. Which one doesn't matter. I barely know. I don't even care. Model number? I couldn't tell you. Maker? I'd pronounce it wrong. I just know it goes up to about 184 degrees Fahrenheit. I bought a sauna on a second-hand recommendation from someone I don't know, but do respect. I bought a sauna sight unseen, heat unfelt. I...



INSIDE THE ALL-HANDS MEETING THAT LED TO **A THIRD OF** BASECAMP EMPLOYEES **QUITTING**

The company's senior leadership wanted to quell employees' concerns, and only made things much, much worse

By Casey Newton | @CaseyNewton | May 3, 2021, 8:00pm EDT

<https://www.theverge.com/2021/5/3/22418208/basecamp-all-hands-meeting-employee-resignations-buyouts-implosion>

But it was an all-hands meeting last Friday, Newton reported, that apparently pushed some employees who were on the fence to actually take the severance offer. Basecamp's longtime head of strategy, Ryan Singer, questioned the existence of white supremacy at the company to the dismay of other employees. Singer, who had been with the company 18 years, eventually resigned.

Even **Forbes** disagrees with basecamp.



<https://www.forbes.com/sites/forbesbooksauthors/2023/03/30/company-culture-and-free-speech-should-certain-subjects-be-verboten/?sh=3467292e2f51>

Case 2: Elon's Husk of Twitter

POLITICO

SIGN UP TO NEWSLETTERS SIGN IN

Musk tells Twitter staff: Work 'hardcore' or leave

Staff told they will have to work 'long hours at high intensity.'

BY LAURA KAYALI

NOVEMBER 16, 2022 | 1:25 PM CET | ⌚ 2 MINUTES READ

<https://www.politico.eu/article/musk-tells-twitter-staff-to-work-harder-or-leave/>

Disconnecting tech from society...

INSIDER INSIDER

Elon Musk says laying off 80% of Twitter's staff was 'painful' and 'one of the hardest things' he's had to do as the platform's boss

Story by mloh@insider.com (Matthew Loh) • Apr 11

<https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/companies/elon-musk-says-laying-off-80-of-twitters-staff-was-painful-and-one-of-the-hardest-things-hes-had-to-do-as-the-platforms-boss/ar-AA19KPWv>

Disconnects morals?



<https://www.inferse.com/485291/elon-musk-publicly-mocks-laid-off-twitter-employee-with-a-disability-then-apologizes-abc-news/>

Current events: Israel-Palestine



DRONES - LATEST NEWS, FEATURES & EXPERT OPINION

MIDDLE EAST

TECHNOLOGY

WAR

Israel Deploys New Military AI in Gaza War



STAFF WRITER WITH AFP X FEBRUARY 12, 2024 3 MINUTES READ

<https://www.thedefensepost.com/2024/02/12/israel-military-ai-gaza/>

Israel-Palestine



Middle East crisis — explained

Israel is using an AI system to find targets in Gaza. Experts say it's just the start

DECEMBER 14, 2023 · 4:58 AM ET

HEARD ON MORNING EDITION



Geoff Brumfiel



<https://www.npr.org/2023/12/14/1218643254/israel-is-using-an-ai-system-to-find-targets-in-gaza-experts-say-its-just-the-st>

Israel-Palestine

IN THESETIMES



The Crackdown on Campus Protests is Just Beginning

At least a dozen colleges and universities have changed their policies to make it harder to protest the war on Gaza. More may follow this summer.

ADAM FEDERMAN

JUNE 20, 2024



<https://inthesetimes.com/article/campus-protest-gaza-indiana-university-columbia-chicago>

Pro-Israeli Tech

Investigation identifies tech entrepreneur behind pro-Israel hate network: Report

A Florida-based tech entrepreneur who co-wrote a guidebook for OnlyFans users is one of the main hands behind the "Shirion Collective", investigation finds

The investigation alleged that Daniel Linden, who co-wrote a guidebook for OnlyFans users, is one of the main hands behind the 'Shirion Collective' (AFP)

By MEE staff

Published date: 29 June 2024 21:35 BST

<https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/investigation-identifies-tech-entrepreneur-behind-pro-israel-hate-network-report>

What about complicity in genocide?

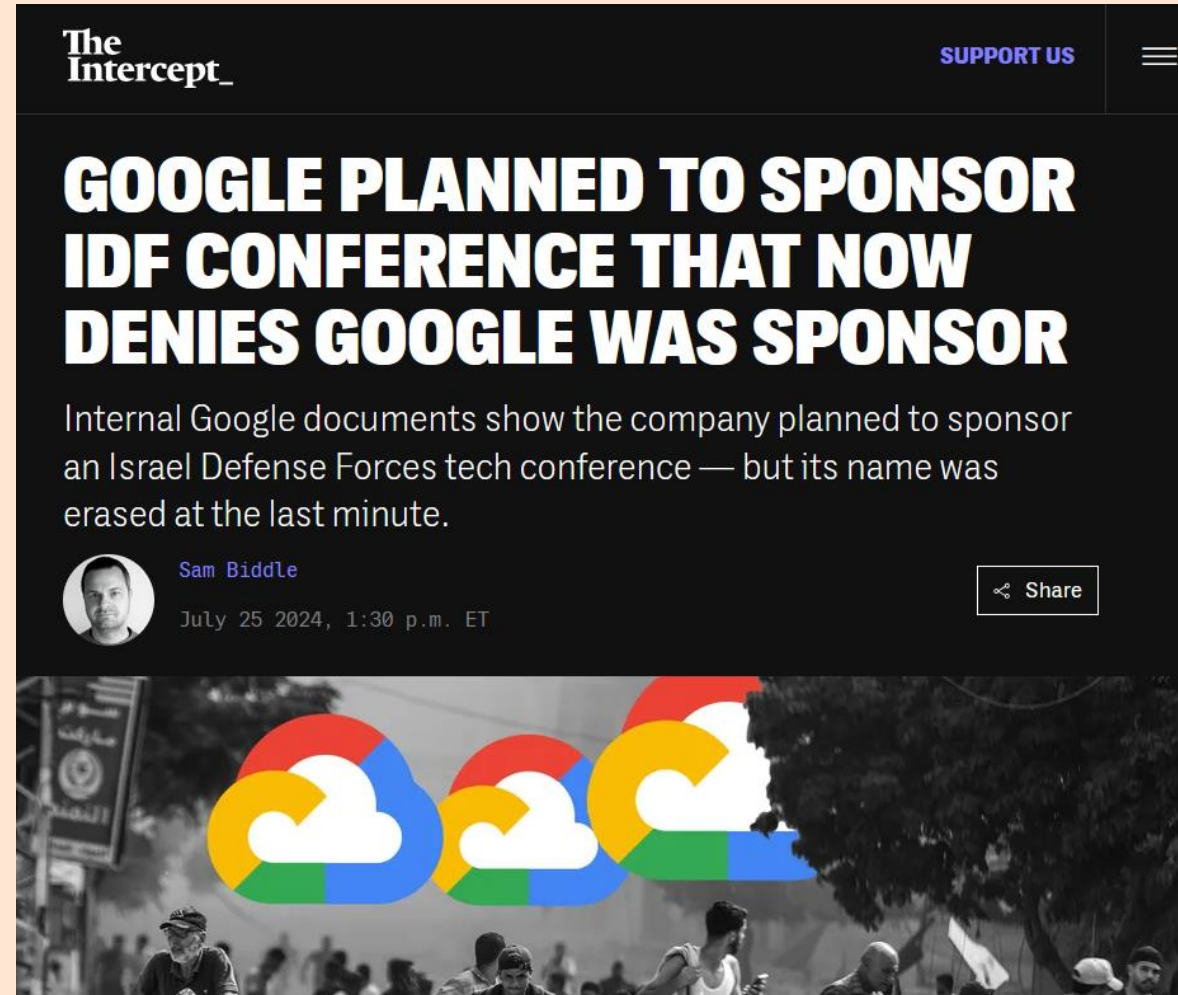
**Israel's genocidal army thanks
the following companies for
their complicity:**



List of sponsors of the *ITforIDF* conference in Tel Aviv.

<https://www.business-humanrights.org/en/latest-news/google-amazon-microsoft-allegedly-complicit-in-war-crimes-amid-israels-war-in-gaza/>

What about hiding their complicity?



<https://theintercept.com/2024/07/25/google-it-idf-tech-conference-sponsor/>

What about complicity in genocide?



<https://www.business-humanrights.org/en/latest-news/google-amazon-microsoft-allegedly-complicit-in-war-crimes-amid-israels-war-in-gaza/>

What about complicity in genocide?

The Washington Post
Democracy Dies in Darkness

Tech Help Desk Artificial Intelligence Internet Culture Space Tech Policy

top EXCLUSIVE

Google rushed to sell AI tools to Israel's military after Hamas attack

The company fulfilled requests from Israel's military for more access to AI tools, as it sought to compete with Amazon, documents obtained by The Post show.

January 21, 2025 More than 1 year ago

<https://www.washingtonpost.com/technology/2025/01/21/google-ai-israel-war-hamas-attack-gaza/>

Connecting AI to Genocide

 Common Dreams 



An aerial view shows Palestinians walking through the ruins of destroyed buildings in the Jabalia refugee camp, northern Gaza Strip, on February 5, 2025. (Photo: Khalil Ramzi Alkahlut/Anadolu via Getty Images)

Probes Reveal Depth of Big Tech Complicity in Israel's AI-Driven Gaza Slaughter

“Many nations are looking to Israel and its use of AI in Gaza with admiration and jealousy,” said one expert. “Expect to see a form of Google, Microsoft, and Amazon-backed AI in other war zones soon.”

 By BRETT WILKINS · Feb 18, 2025

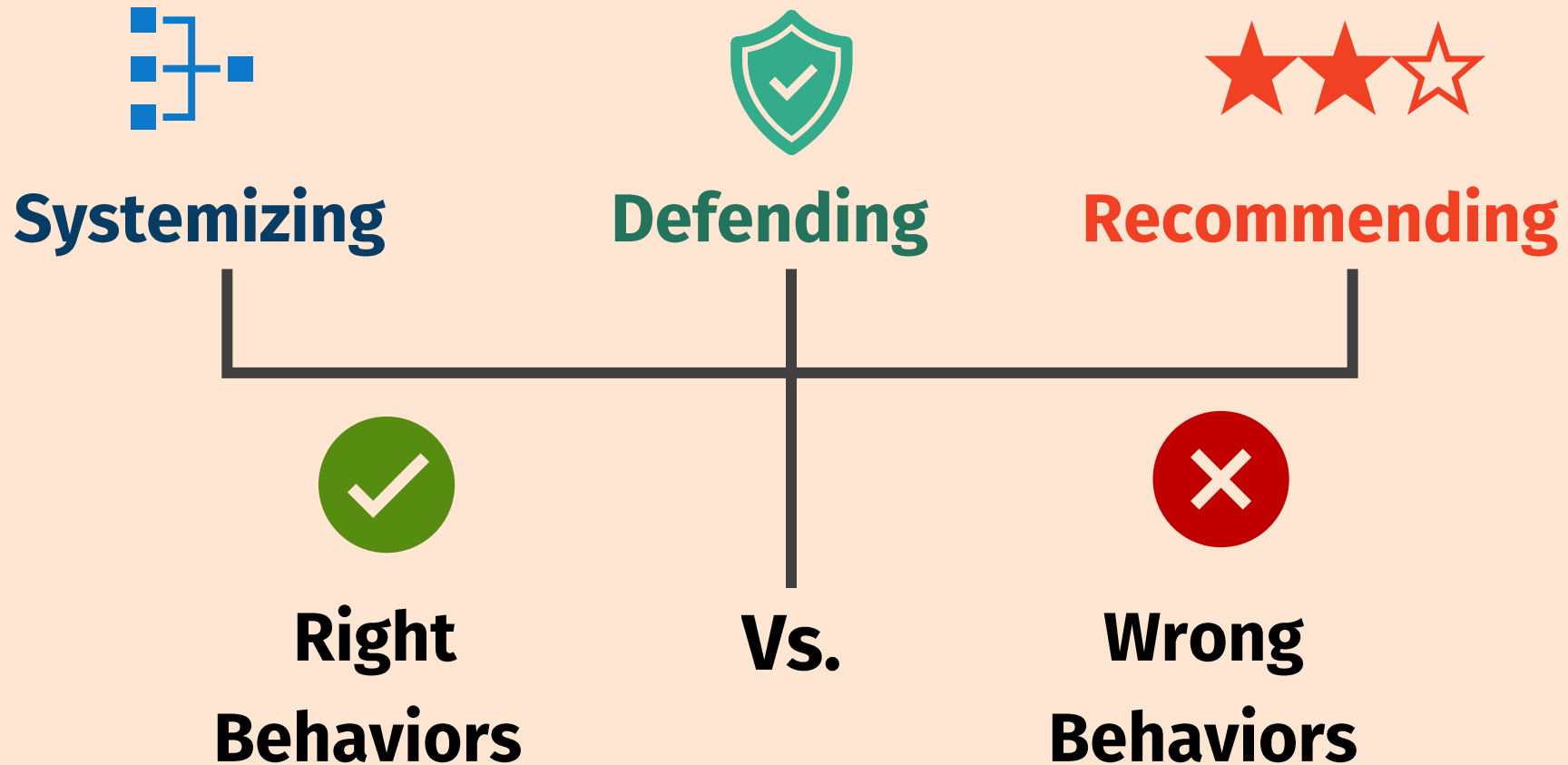
<https://www.commondreams.org/news/big-tech-gaza-genocide>

Analyzing all this looks like a job for.....

Ethic



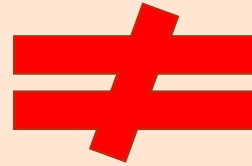
Reminder, ethics is about:



Understanding why we should be doing an action.

No “right” answers

No right
answers



No answers

We should be able to **systemize**, **defend**, and **recommend**
what is **right** or **wrong** for ourselves.

We can still afford to debate though!



Disagreeing and debating on ethics leads to STRONGER ethics for everyone!

Three ethical terms to walk away with today



Technological Determinism



Techno-facism



Holism

I will explain my ethics on what is bad, and if you disagree, then I should be able to defend it to make my ethical case stronger!

Connecting the dots of technology and ethics

Technology, Society, and Ethics



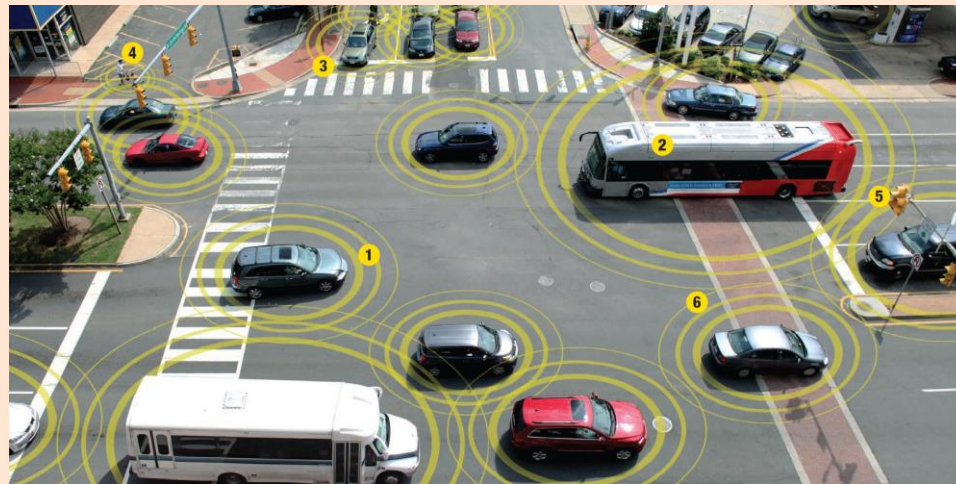
Lecture

Visiting Voice

Group Time

Technology

- **Objects that provide a “solution” to a problem**
- **Technique of knowledge**
- **Set of objects that exist only within certain social relations.**



Technology

When we think about technology as an “object” we cut it out of the social context that it exists in.

This causes:

- **Commodification of technology**
- **Fetishizing technology**

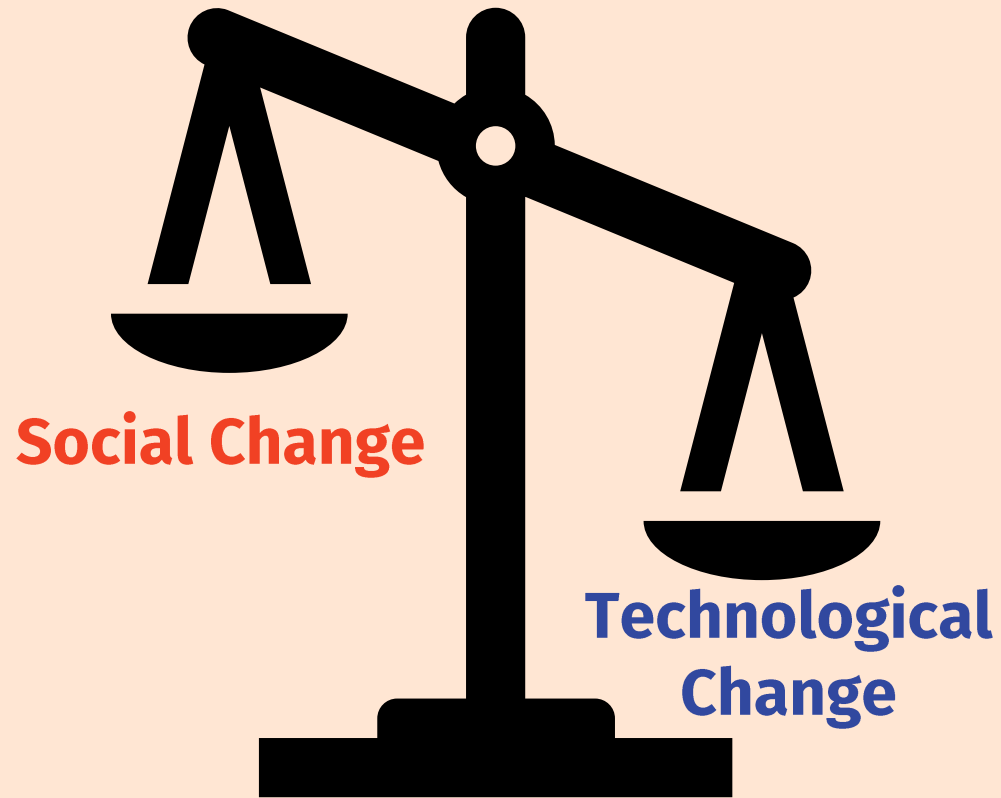


Society

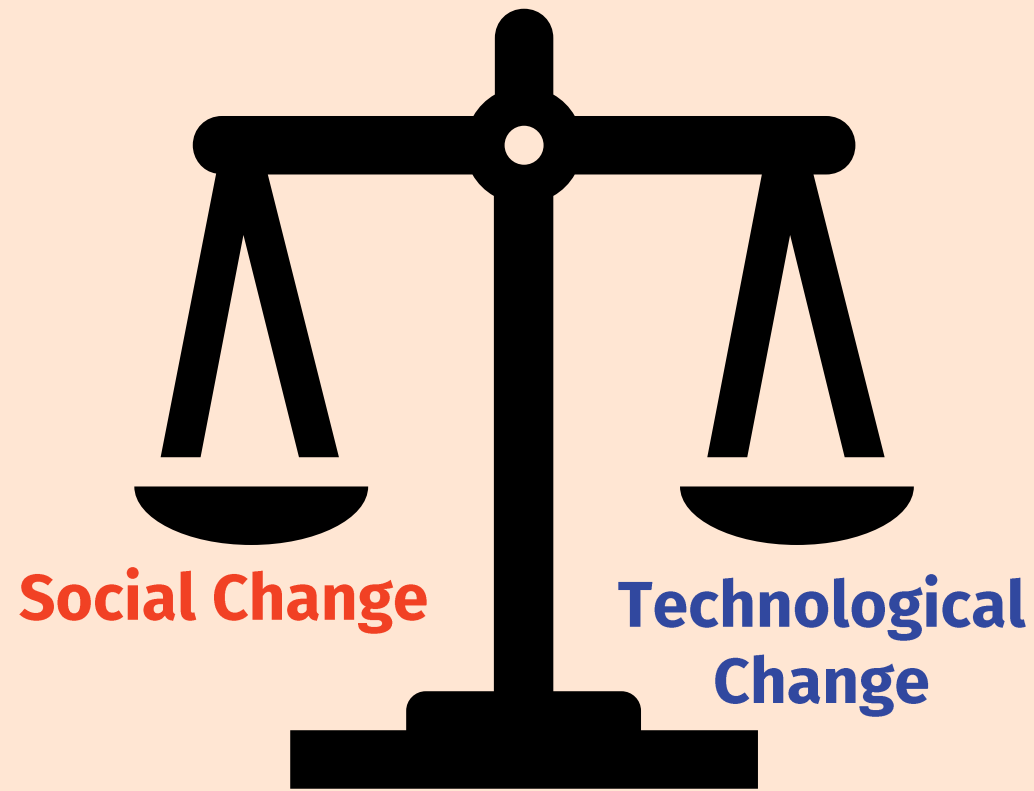


“We live in a society”

As a society where we are at:



Where we need to be:



Why is this the current state?

We have tools to solve social issues like:

- **Hunger**
- **Climate change**
- **Police brutality**
- **Houselessness**

But....

We spend resources on trying to find “new” bigger and better technical solutions instead of addressing root causes.

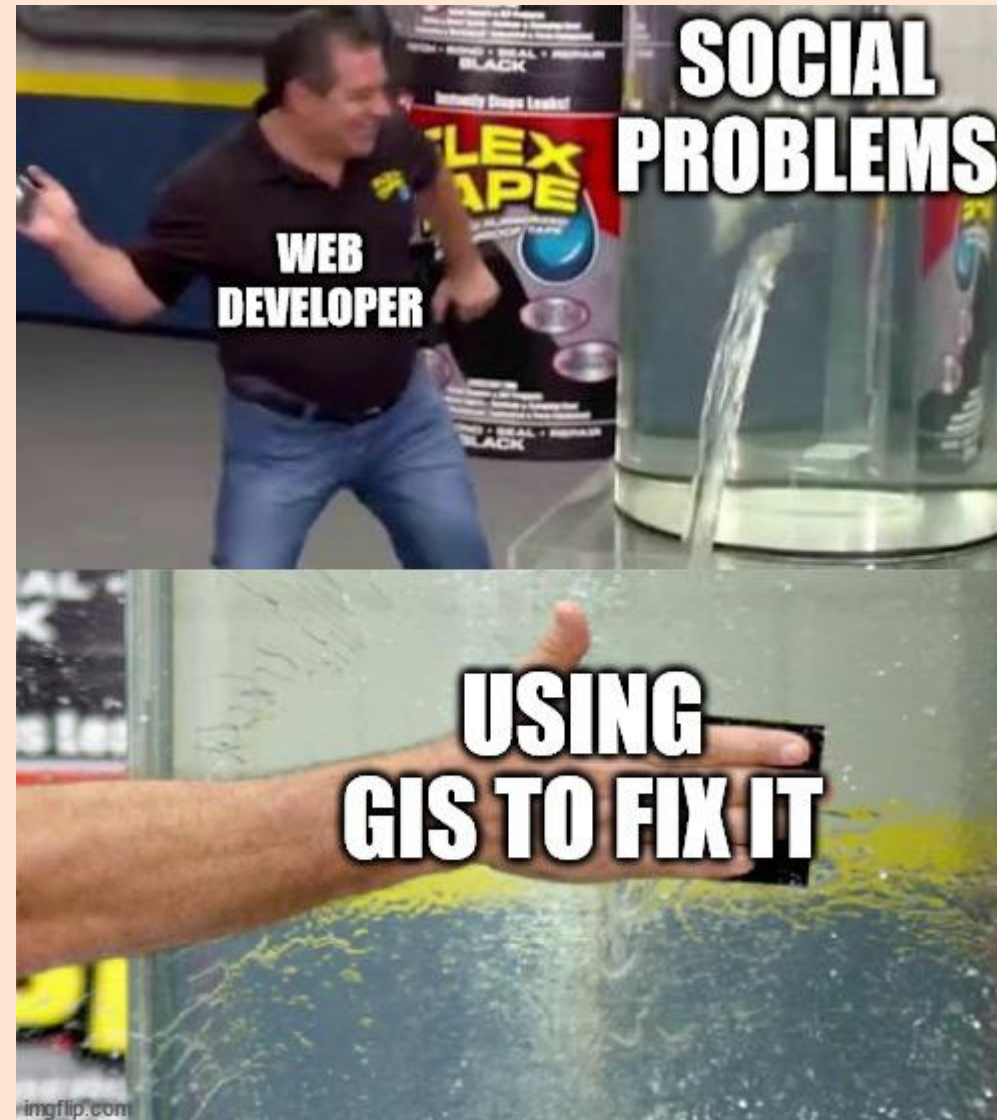
Why?

It's easier to invest in or create new technology than to face the causes of social problems.

My main ethical point today

You cannot solve social problems with just technology.

Don't be this type of web developer



**Even “scientific” problems are more effected
by society than technology...**

Any examples?

LEONARDO
DiCAPRIO

JENNIFER
LAWRENCE

ROB MORGAN JONAH HILL MARK RYLANCE TYLER PERRY TIMOTHÉE CHALAMET RON PERLMAN ARIANA GRANDE SCOTT MESCUDI WITH CATE BLANCHETT AND MERYL STREEP

Don't Look

UP

BASED ON
TRULY
POSSIBLE
EVENTS

A FILM BY ADAM MCKAY
DON'T LOOK UP

NETFLIX PRESENTS A HYPEROBJECT INDUSTRIES PRODUCTION A FILM BY ADAM MCKAY LEONARDO DiCAPRIO JENNIFER LAWRENCE "DON'T LOOK UP" ROB MORGAN JONAH HILL MARK RYLANCE TYLER PERRY TIMOTHÉE CHALAMET RON PERLMAN ARIANA GRANDE SCOTT MESCUDI WITH CATE BLANCHETT AND MERYL STREEP CASTING BY FRANCINE MAISLER MUSIC BY NICHOLAS BRITTELL COSTUME DESIGNER SUSAN MATHESON EDITOR HANK CORWIN, ACE PRODUCTION DESIGNER CLAYTON HARTLEY DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY LINUS SANDGREN, ASC, FSC CO-PRODUCER RON SUSKIND EXECUTIVE PRODUCER JEFF WAXMAN PRODUCED BY ADAM MCKAY, P.G.A. & KEVIN MESSICK, P.G.A. STORY BY ADAM MCKAY & DAVID SIROTA SCREENPLAY BY ADAM MCKAY DIRECTED BY ADAM MCKAY

HYPEROBJECT
INDUSTRIES



IN SELECT THEATERS DECEMBER AND ON

NETFLIX

NETFLIX | DECEMBER 24

[Health Topics ▾](#)[Countries ▾](#)[Newsroom ▾](#)[Emergencies ▾](#)[Data ▾](#)[About WHO ▾](#)

COVAX

Working for global equitable access to COVID-19 vaccines

02.16.2022

SARAH LAZARE



Pharmaceutical Monopolies Are Still Preventing Full Access to COVID Vaccines Around the World

South African scientists are nearly finished reverse engineering Moderna's COVID-19 vaccine. They are forced to waste precious time and resources recreating a vaccine that already exists, because for-profit science protects industry profits over human life.

<https://www.jacobinmag.com/2022/02/pharmaceutical-monopolies-access-covid-19-vaccine-global-south-moderna-patents>

AI Data Centers

moneyWise

'It's an irrefutable fact': Kevin O'Leary says China is funding a 'PR war' against data centers in America

Becky Robertson

June 1, 2026 • 5 min read



10



<https://finance.yahoo.com/economy/policy/articles/irrefutable-fact-kevin-oleary-says-185500320.html>

AI Data Centers

Utah senator, Fox News apologize for linking data center foes to China

Tim Vandenack

Wed, July 1, 2026 at 1:03 PM · 4 min read
PDT



Media apologizes for the error*

FOX STAFF
1:03 PM



ANCHOR: Meanwhile there's this, Kevin O'Leary...

...his planned data center project in Utah. No...

...the opponents of that project. Mr. O'Leary...

...the opponents of that project. Mr. O'Leary...



TO REDUCE DATA CEI

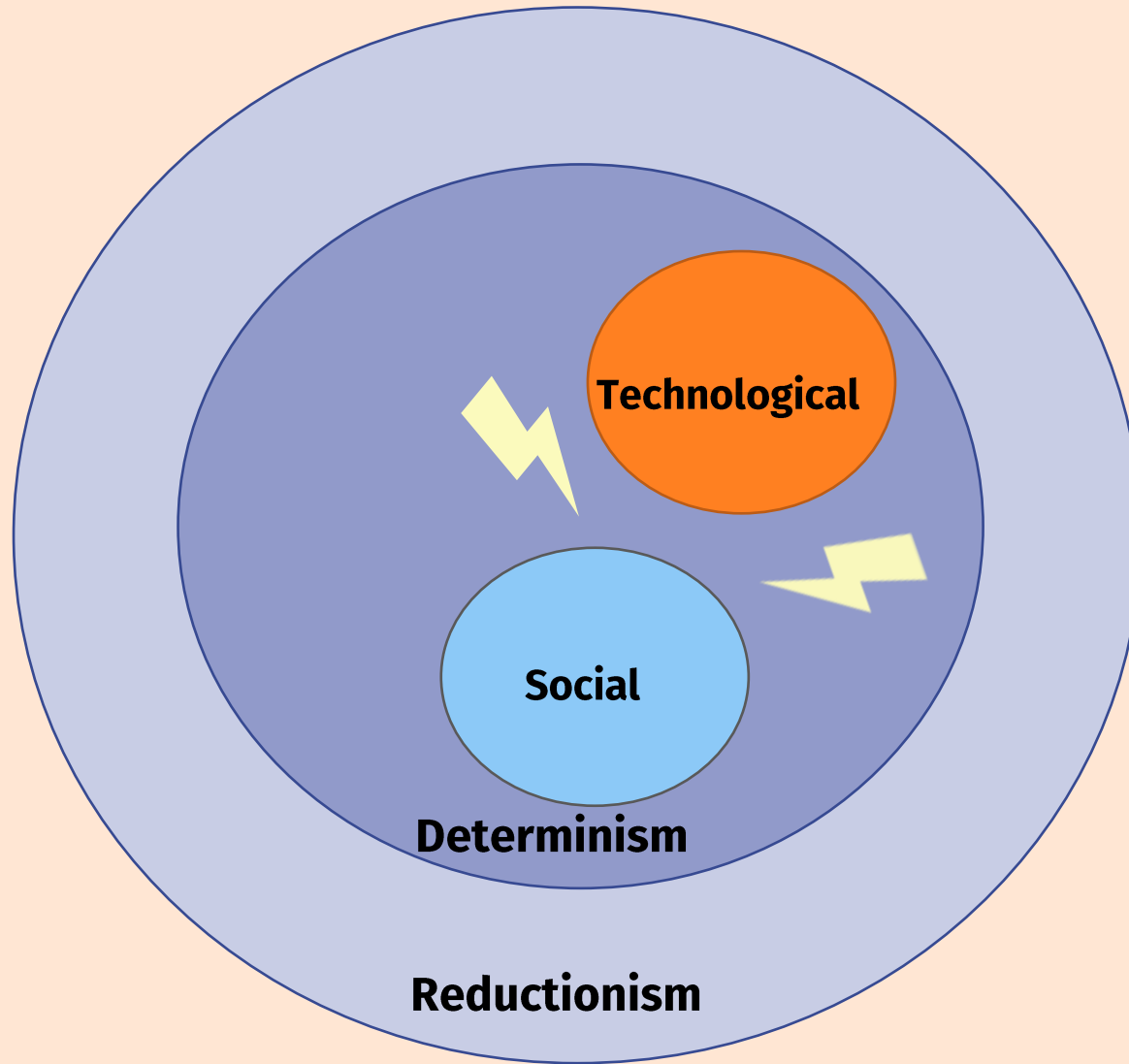


<https://finance.yahoo.com/economy/policy/articles/irrefutable-fact-kevin-oleary-says-185500320.html>

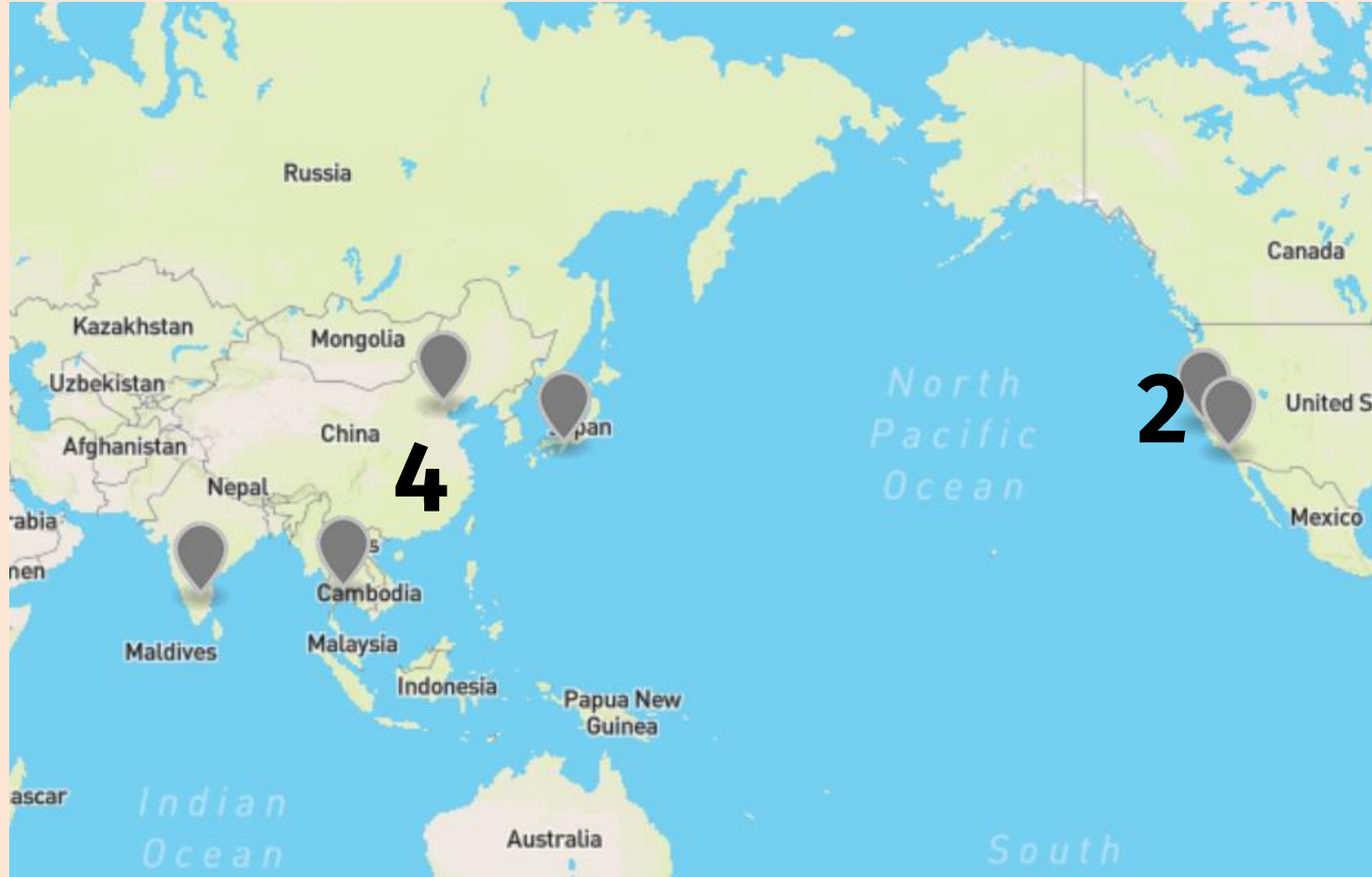
Time to SET the stage with some philosophy

What do you call the idea reducing something into simpler components?

Reductionism



Reductionism

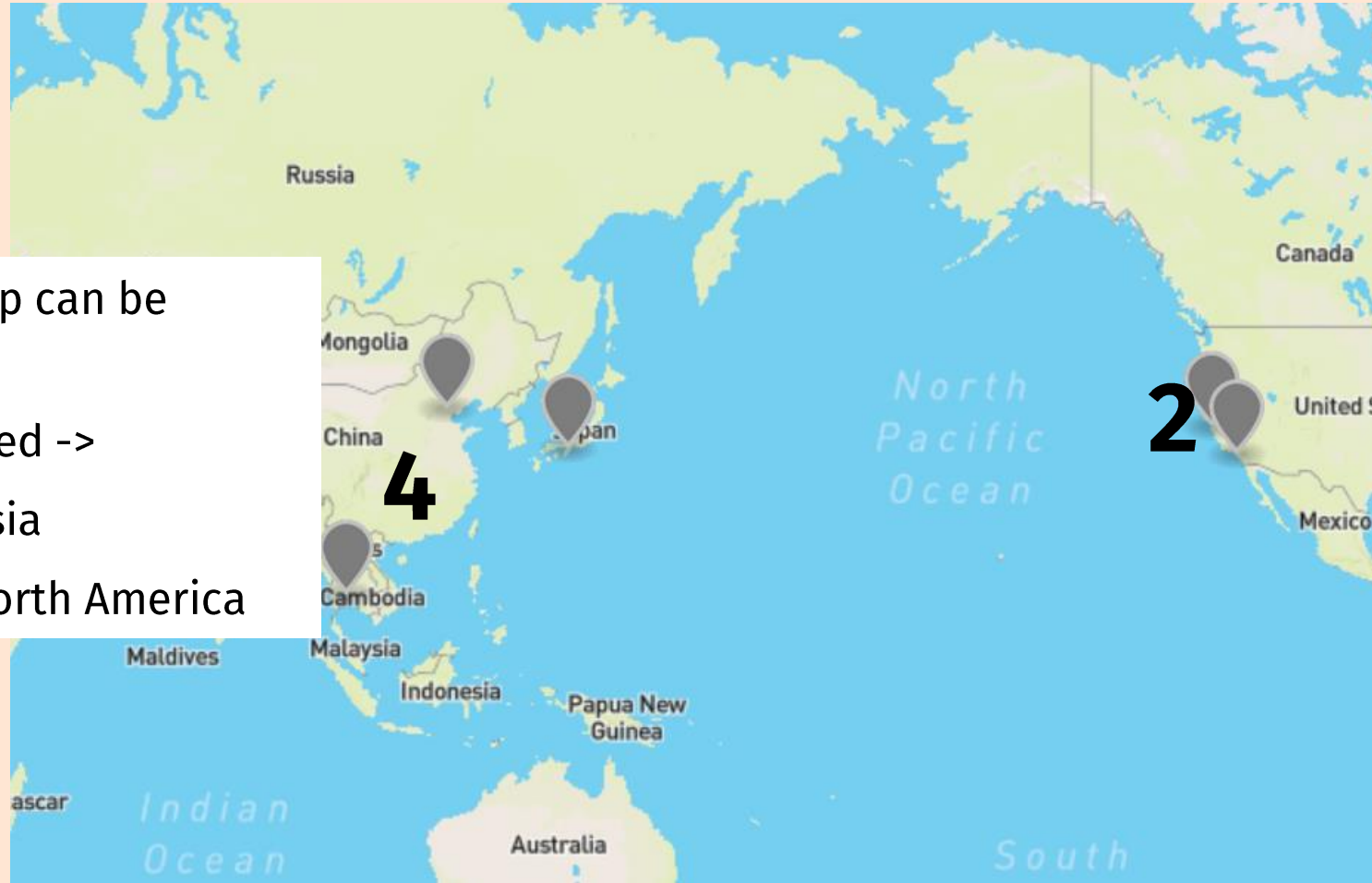


In the social sciences:
Reduces qualitative data into quantitative.

Reductionism

For example... this map can be reduced to:

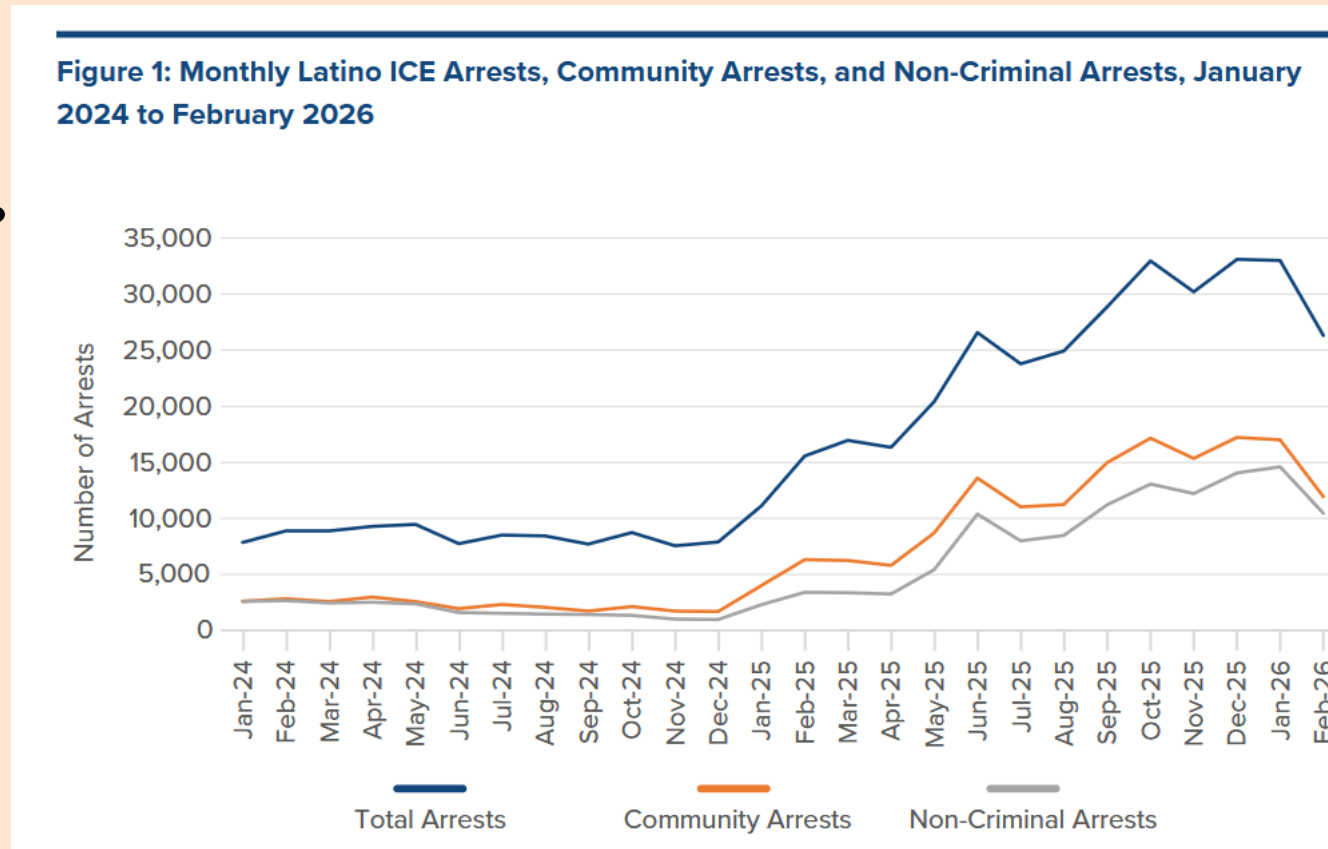
- Places where I lived ->
 - 4 points in Asia
 - 2 points in North America



Reducing my experiences to numbers on a continent, introduces a loss of information. Which country in Asia did I live in??

Reductionism – In ICE

Where's the people?



<https://luskin.ucla.edu/new-center-for-neighborhood-knowledge-analysis-undercuts-worst-of-the-worst-deportation-claims>

Reductionism – In ICE

**Working Title: The Cost of Fear: The Impacts of
Immigration Enforcement on Small Businesses and
Latino Entrepreneurs in LA County**

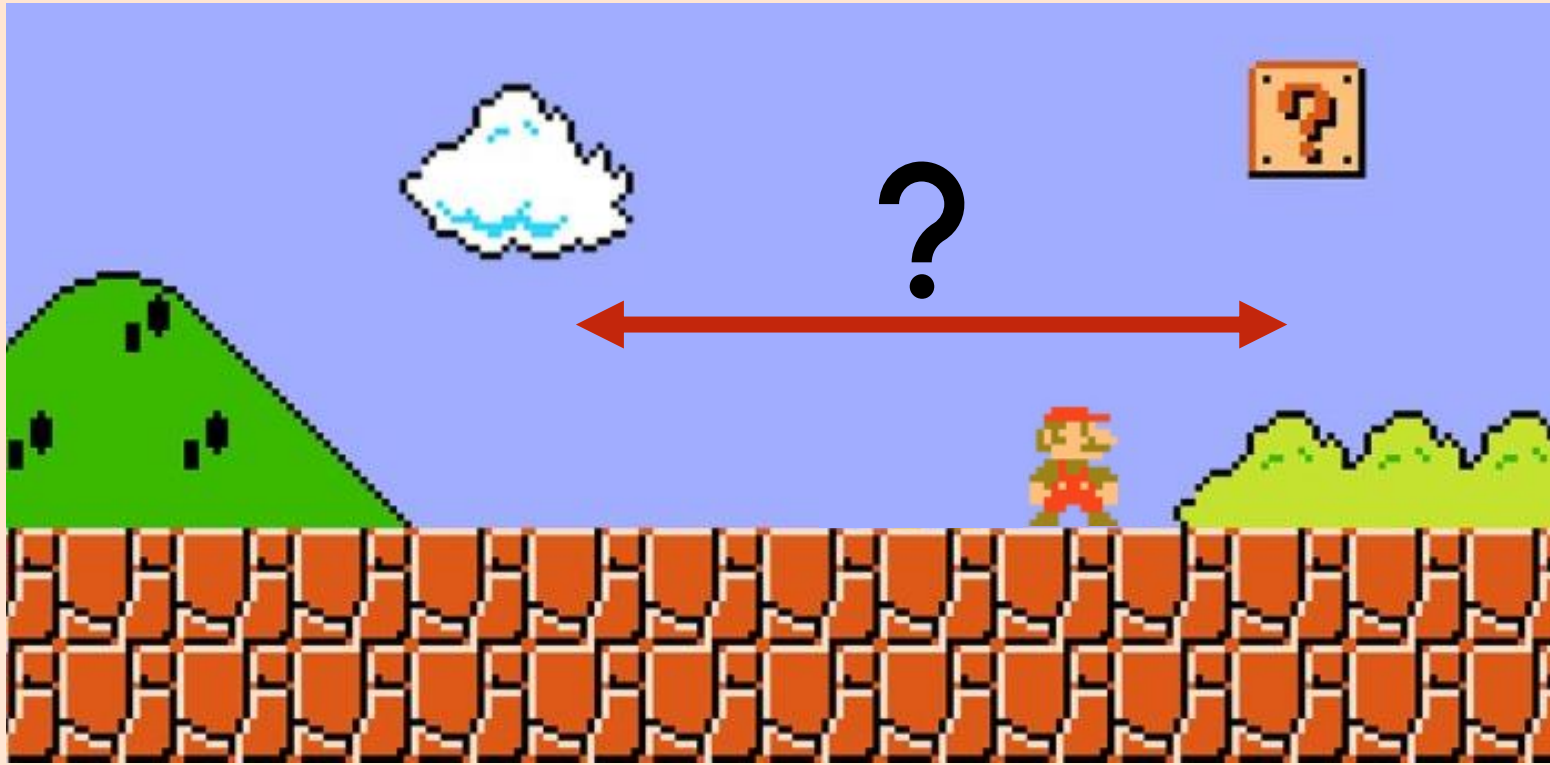
Amada Armenta, Nicholas Vargas, Albert Kochaphum, Ariana J. Valle, Miriam
Torres Sanchez, G. Cristina Mora, Silvia R. González

Reductionism



<https://www.npr.org/2025/11/08/nx-s1-5585691/ice-facial-recognition-immigration-tracking-spyware>

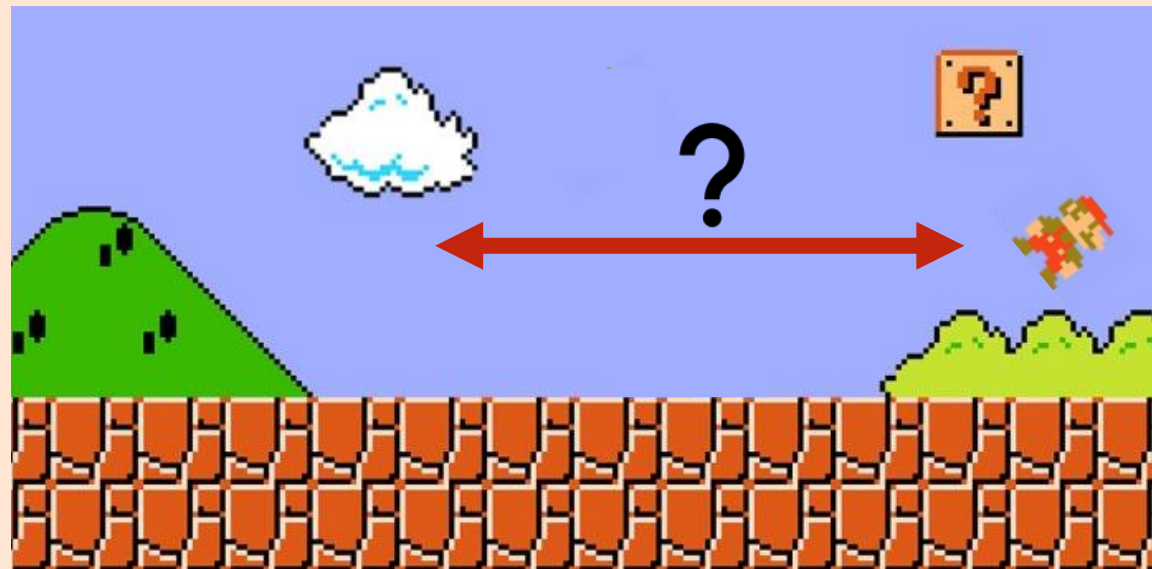
Determinism



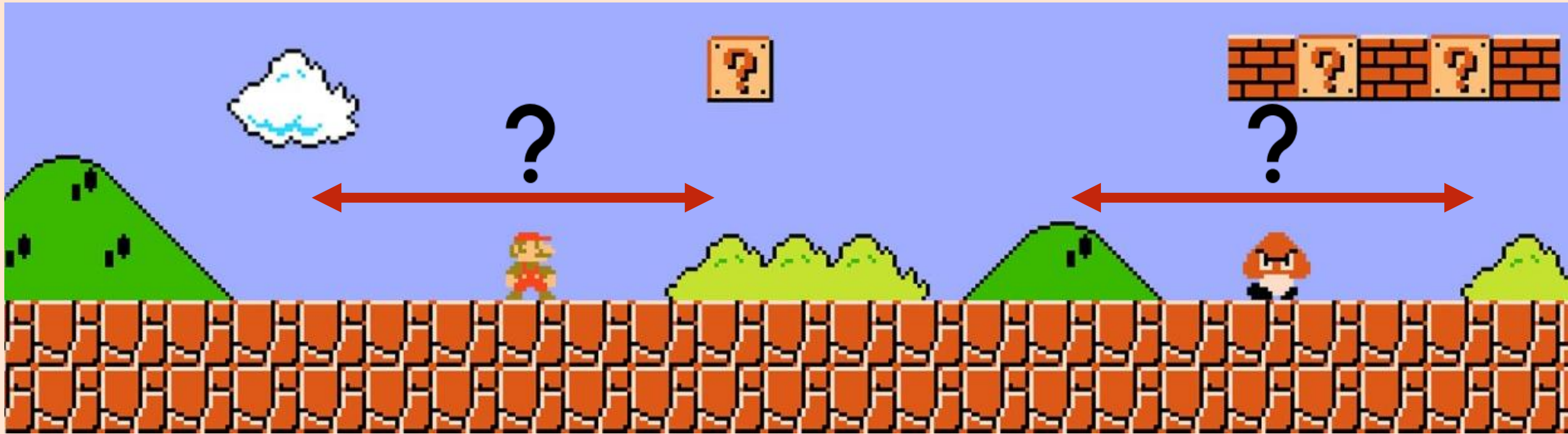
All our actions are pre-determined because it is governed by systems

Free-Will

Systems are chaotic so there no pre-determined events can be attributed to them



Compatibilists



Determinism and free-will can co-exist.

Ex. Mario and the goomba are free to go any way,
but WITHIN a pre-defined system

Technological Determinism

The idea that technology will solve all social problems.

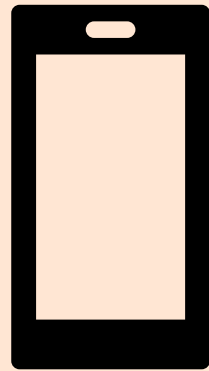
Example: We can “invent” our way out of climate change.

Technological Determinism

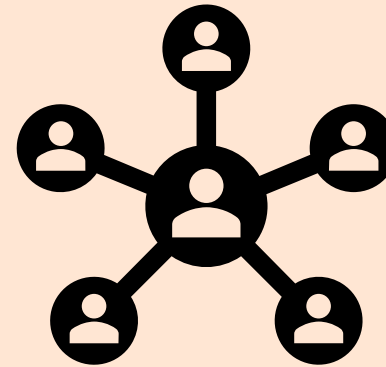


Technological Determinism

Technology



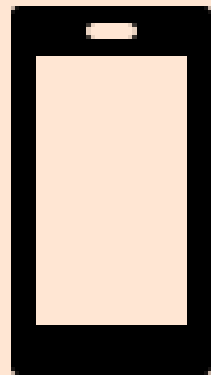
Society



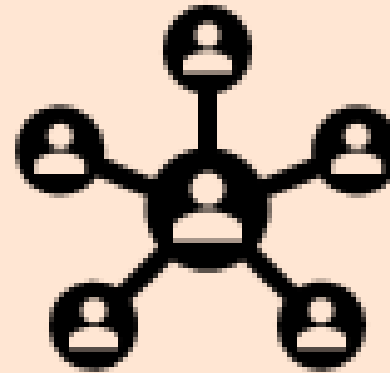
Technology is the force that changes **society**

Technological Determinism

Technology



Society

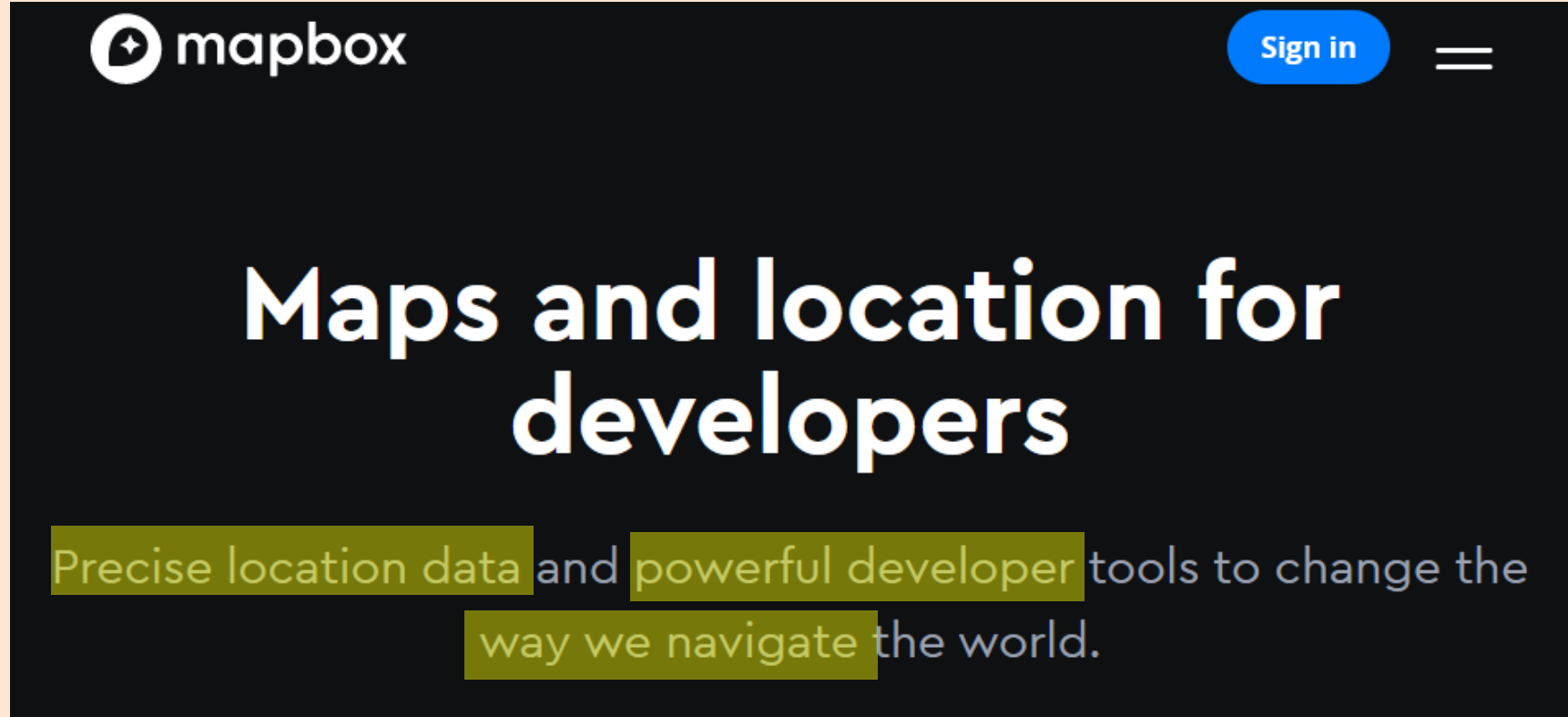


“Phones will improve people’s life.”

Let's apply this to mapping



Mapping Technologies



Mapbox is for DEVELOPERS!

Mapping Technologies

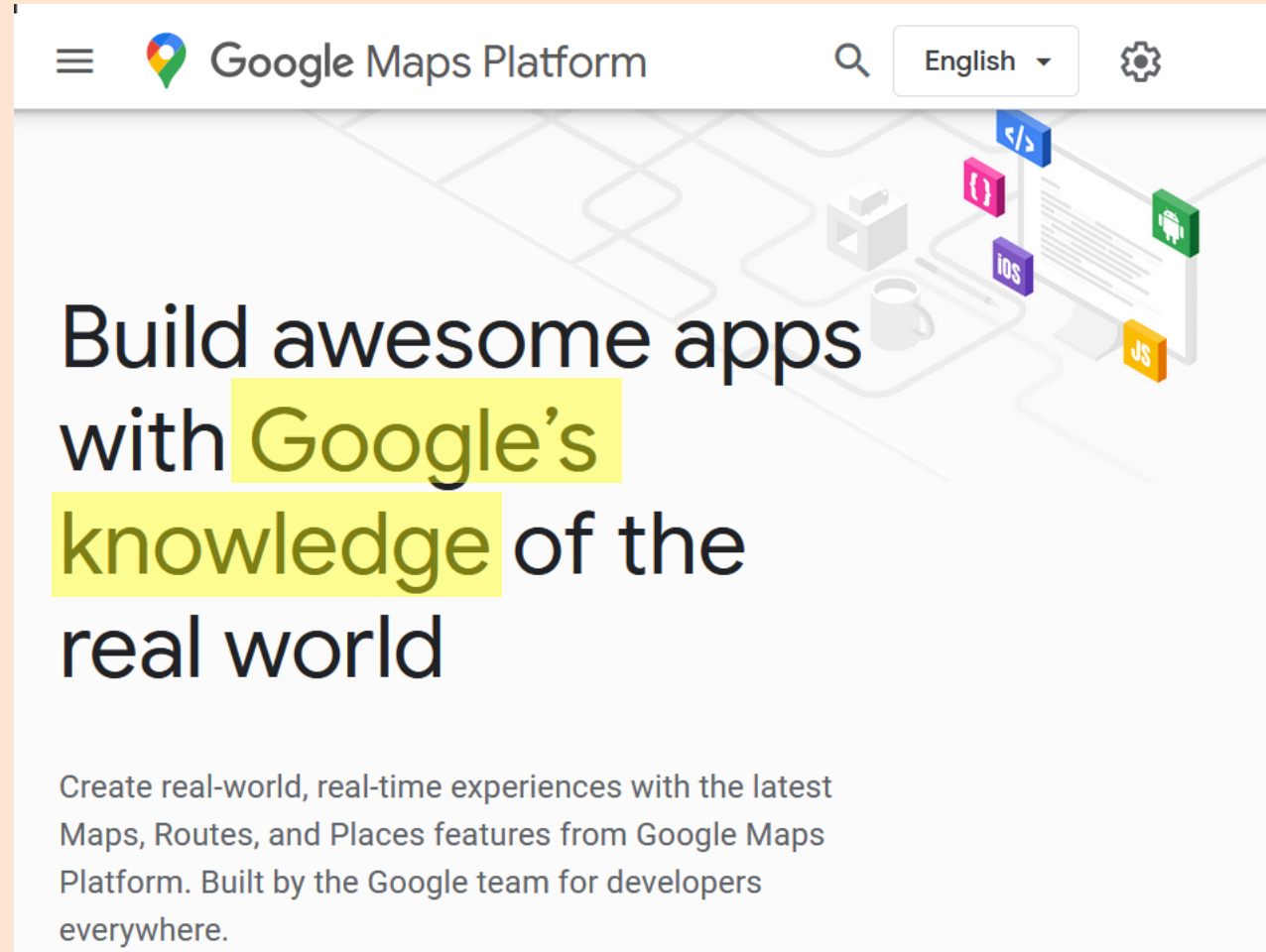


Unlock the **power** of
spatial analysis

The only cloud-native Location Intelligence platform

CARTO is for SPATIAL ANALYSIS

Mapping Technologies



Use Google's KNOWLEDGE to BUILD!

Mapping Technologies



Discover your POWER with ArcGIS!

Why are these examples problematic?

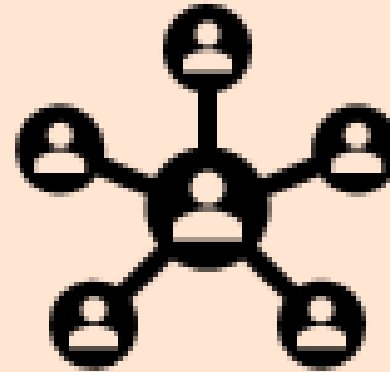
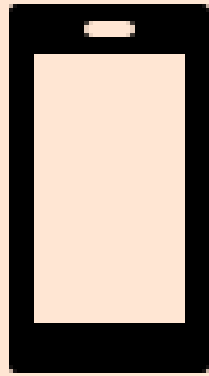
Separates society's role in creating the technologies.

Social Determinism

Social Determinism

Technology

Society

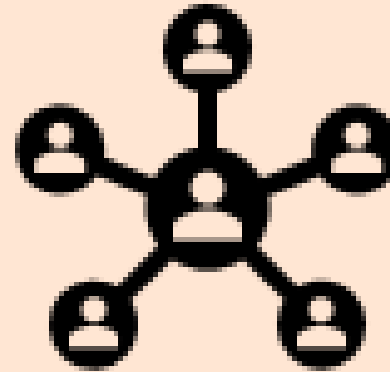
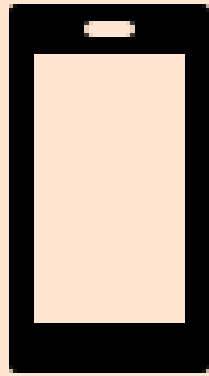


Technology is a result of the society

Social Determinism

Technology

Society



“People created phones to talk easier.”

Examples



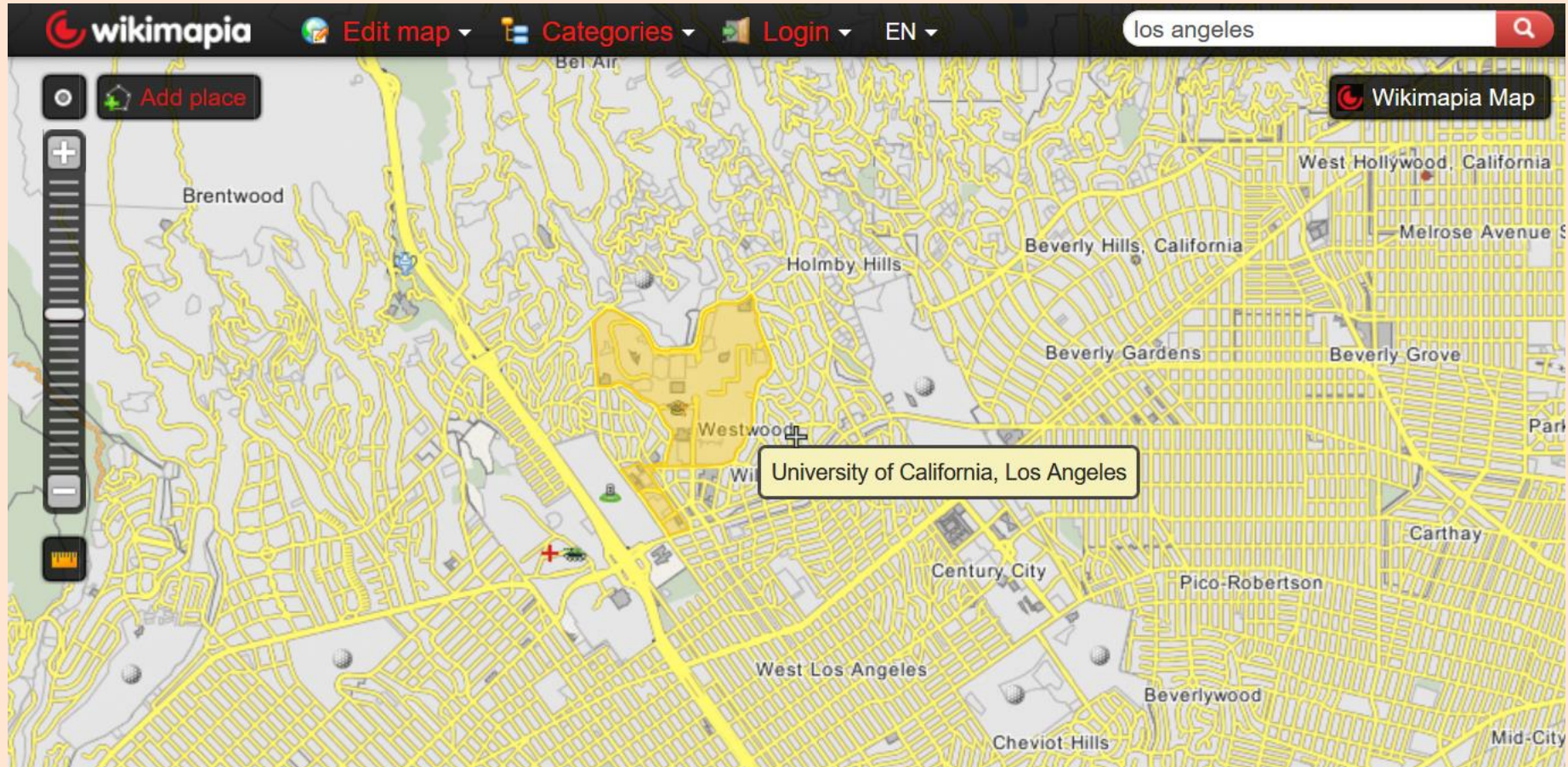
an open-source JavaScript library
for mobile-friendly interactive maps

Examples

MapLibre GL JS

Open-source TypeScript library for publishing maps on your website. Great performance due to GPU-accelerated vector tile rendering.

Examples



Recapping

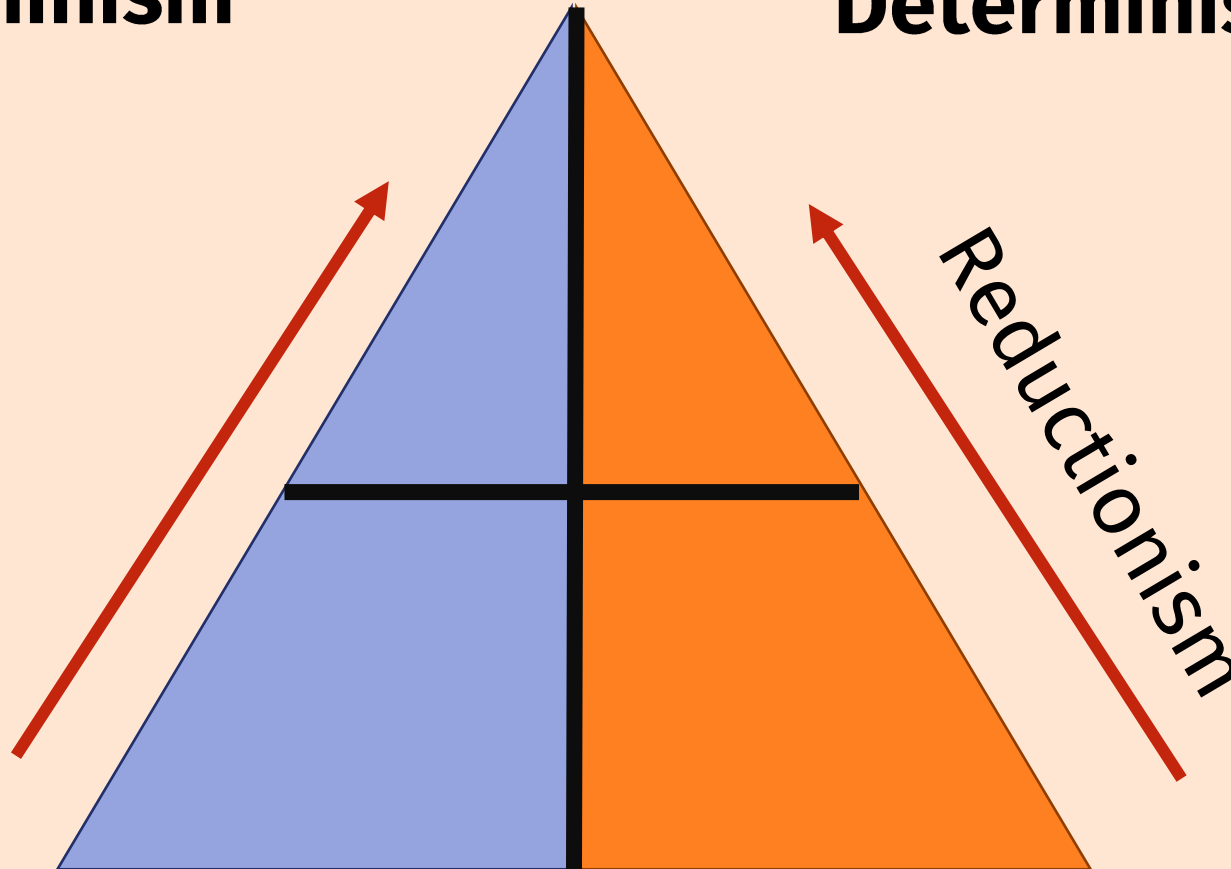
**Technological
Determinism**

Vs.

**Social
Determinism**

Hard

Soft



Main takeaway

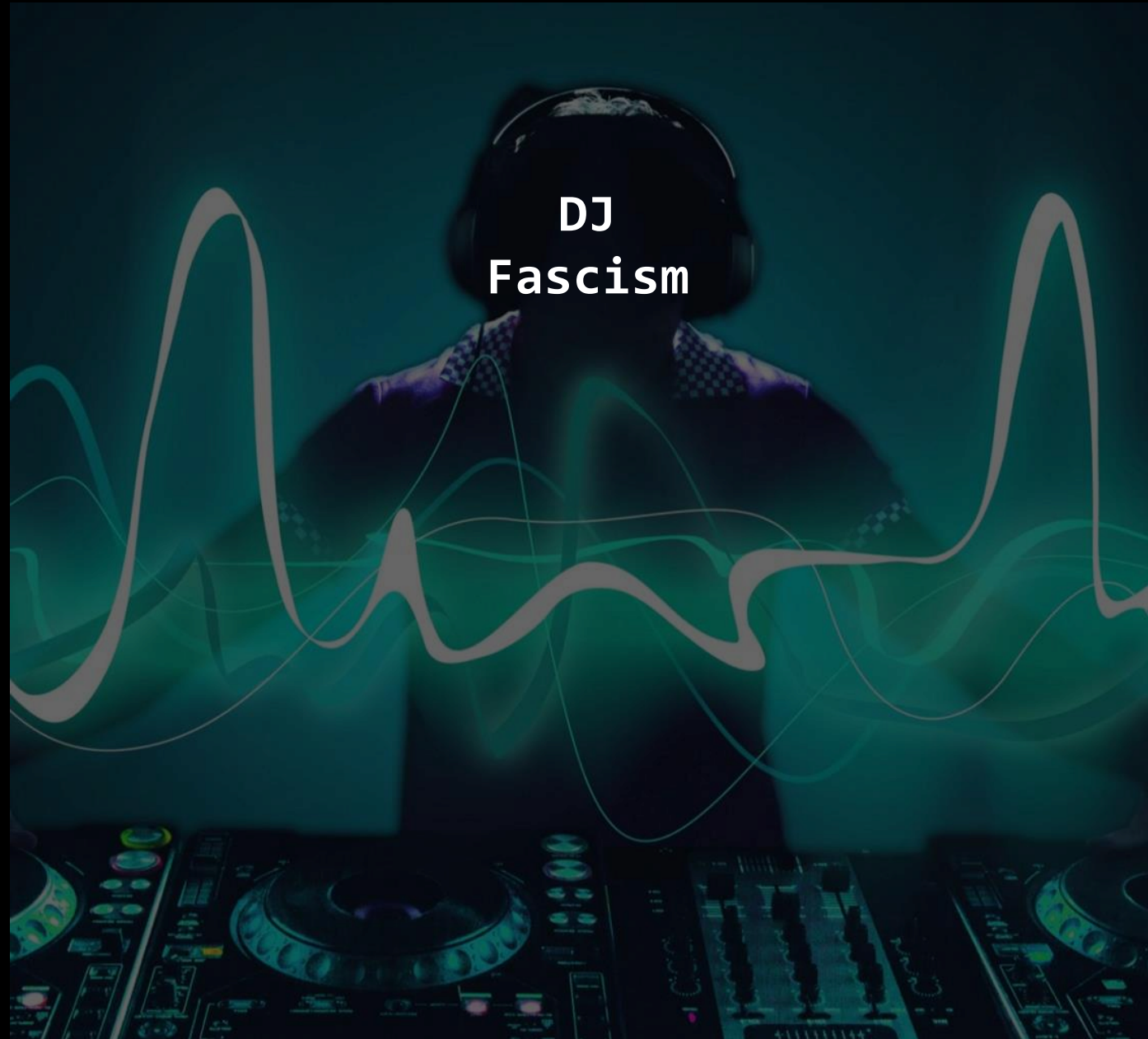
Reductionism is problematic because it only re-aligns the balance in one direction.



**Wait.. This is a technology skills class..
Shouldn't we focus on technology solutions?**

No, because.. It leads to...

Techno-Fascism



Technocracy/Techno-Fascism

Fascism – Oppression of opposing thoughts

Technocracy – Rule by only those with expertise

Techno-Fascism = **Fascism** + **Technocracy**

Technocracy/Techno-Fascism

Techno-Fascism – Rule by those with expertise
that oppresses opposing thoughts

Techno-Fascism

‘Unstoppable’ AI raises concerns, need for regulation

By: Kathryn McNutt // The Journal Record // April 13, 2023

“Big tech, machine learning, AI is too big and inevitable, people cannot stand up against it.”

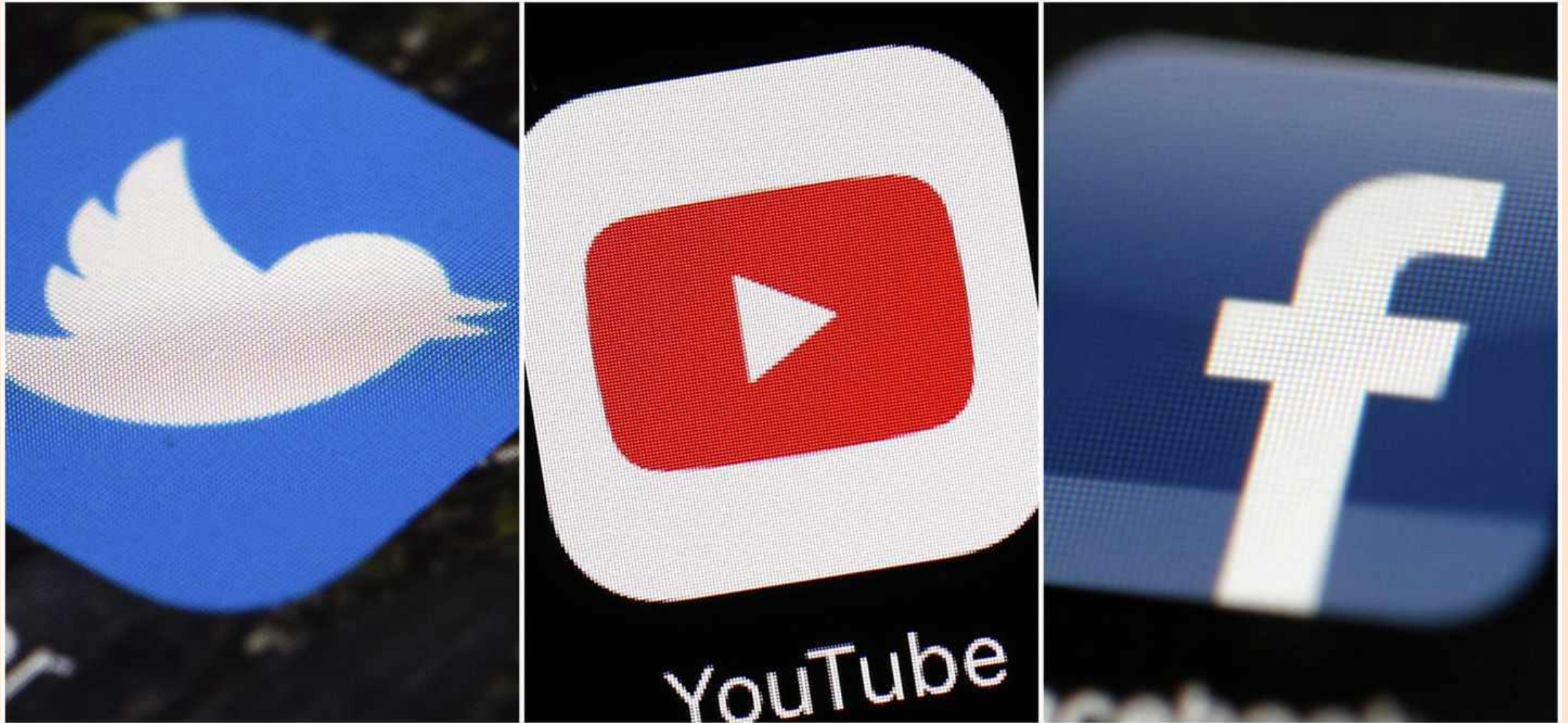
Techno-Fascism

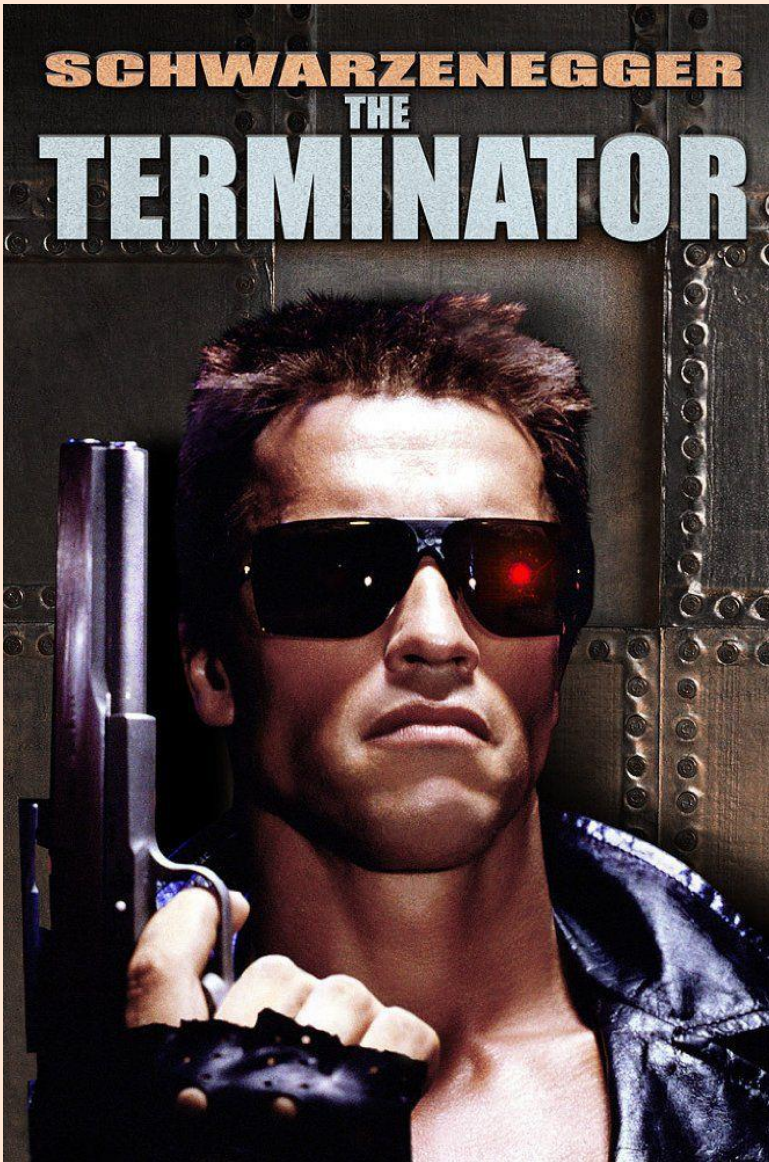
‘Unstoppable’ AI raises concerns, need for regulation

By: Kathryn McNutt // The Journal Record // April 13, 2023

“Big tech, machine learning, AI is too big and inevitable, people cannot stand up against it.”

Techno-Fascism





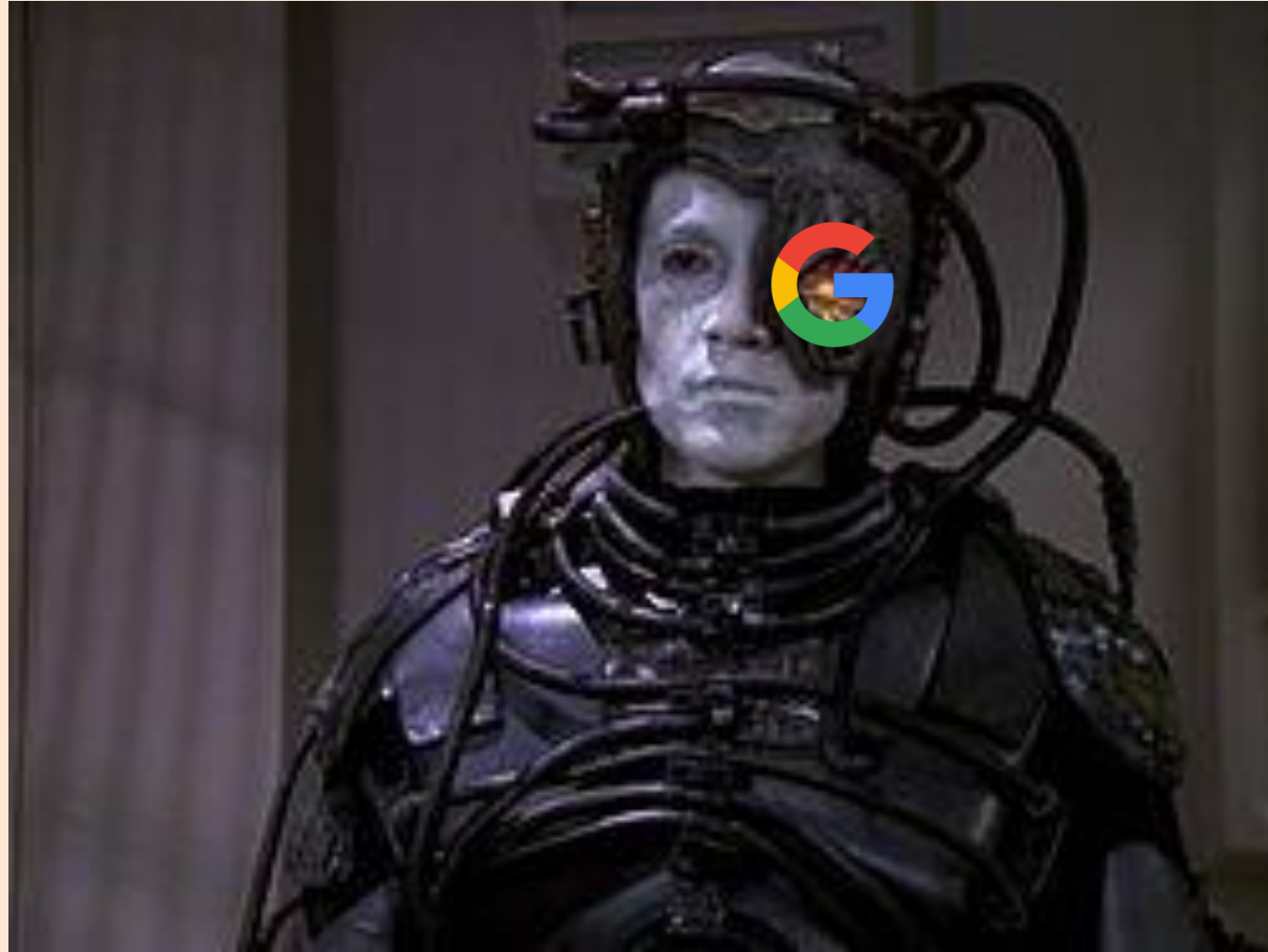
OF FREEDOM

Hasta la vista freedom

What it really means is

“I have more ‘technical’ skills and know more than you, so I am better than you, do not resist.”

-Every Big Tech CEO



Resistance is futile.

Assignments

Due July 7/8:

1. Lab Assignment #2
2. Group Assignment #2 (end of day)
3. Pre-lab (optional)

Due July 7/13:

1. Thinking Cap #3
2. Weekly Reading

Yoh Kawano

Visiting Voice

Lecture

Visiting Voice

Group Time

A long time ago in a (UCLA building) not too far away

**SAVE US FROM NON-COMMUNITY FOCUSED
GROUP PROJECTS.....**

YOU ARE OUR ONLY HOPE  **YOHDA KAWANOBI**

YOH(DA) KAWANO





Visiting Voice: Yoh Kawano



Yoh Kawano is a digital humanist, former Lead Computation Scientist at UCLA's Institute for Digital Research and Technology, and associate professor at Reitaku University Japan (Japanese). His community empowerment is on narratives in Japan's Fukushima prefecture following the 2011 Tsunami.